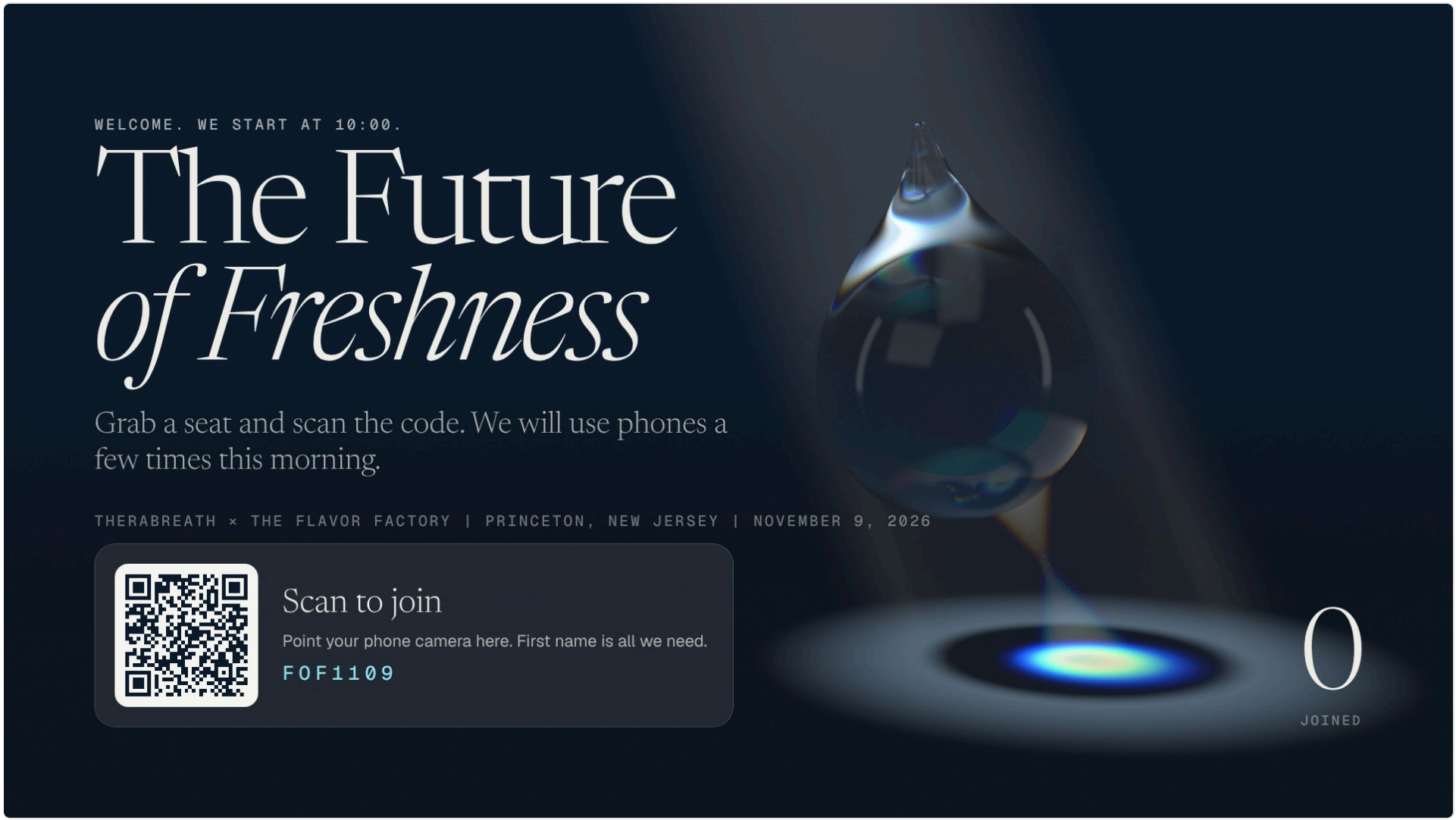
PRESENTER EDITION · 10:00 TO 12:00 · MONDAY, NOVEMBER 9, 2026 · DARWIN ROOM, PRINCETON

The Future *of Freshness*

Every scene as it will look on the TV, at its last build, with the time and the talking points. It is a discussion. Each of Ross's four objectives opens in his words and ends with questions for everyone. People vote from their phones four times, and what we decide together is typed in live and becomes the Playbook at the end. 35 scenes, plus "Your pre-brief answers" once the answers are in. The live presentation is at /host: right arrow or click to go on, F for full screen, N for the talking points.

TIME	PART	OBJECTIVE	SCENES
10:00 to 10:10	Welcome, who we are, and your four objectives		1 to 6
10:10 to 10:25	What's changing: your portfolio, the market and seven trends	01	7 to 12
10:25 to 10:40	Flavor School and four directions	02	13 to 22
10:40 to 11:00	A blind tasting in your bases	02	23 to 25
11:00 to 11:20	From samples to concepts	03	26 to 28
11:20 to 11:40	White space, then Now, Next, Later	04	29 to 31
11:40 to 12:00	What we decided, next steps, and a short film before lunch		32 to 35

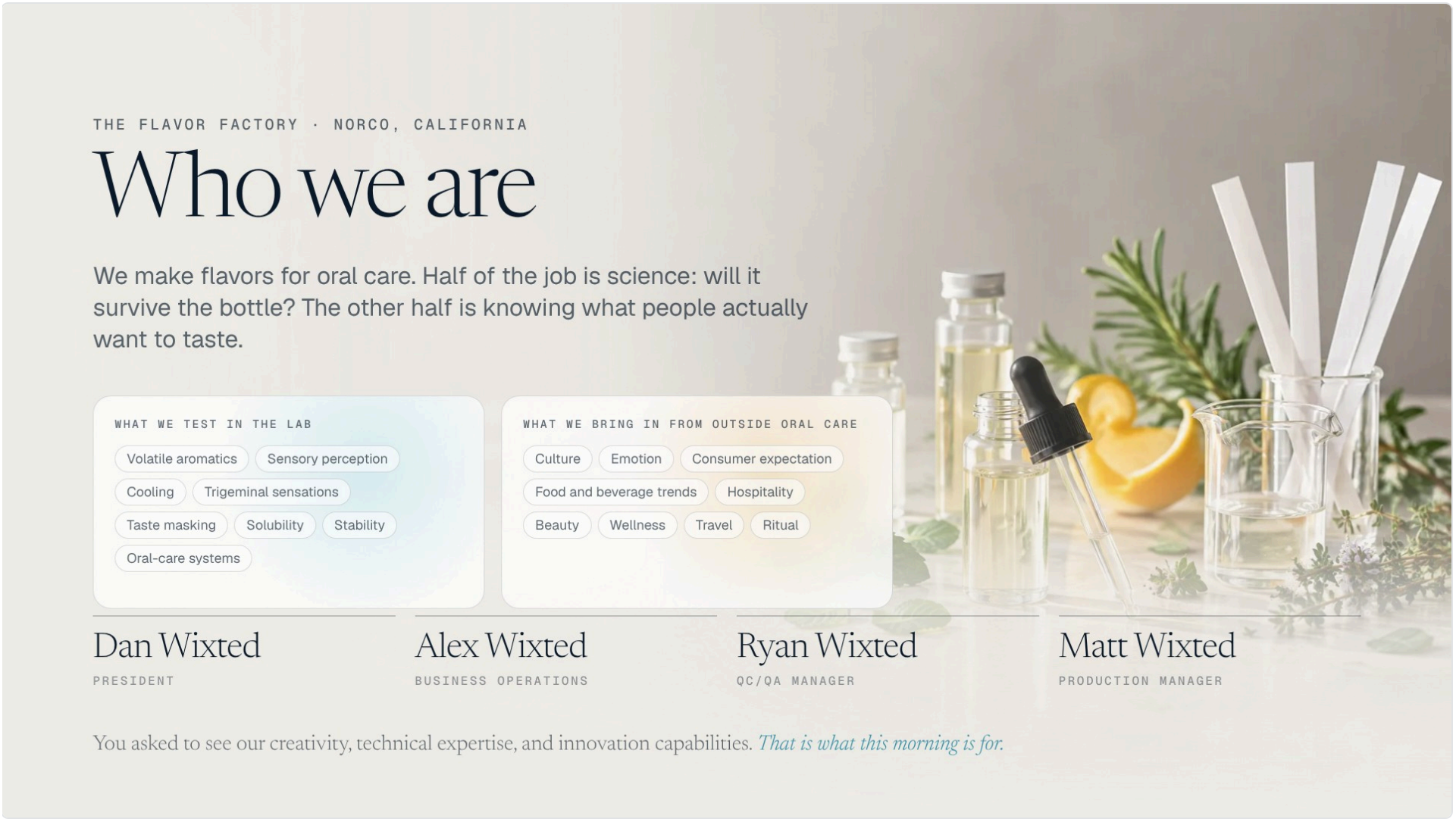
Confidential. For The Flavor Factory team; not for distribution.



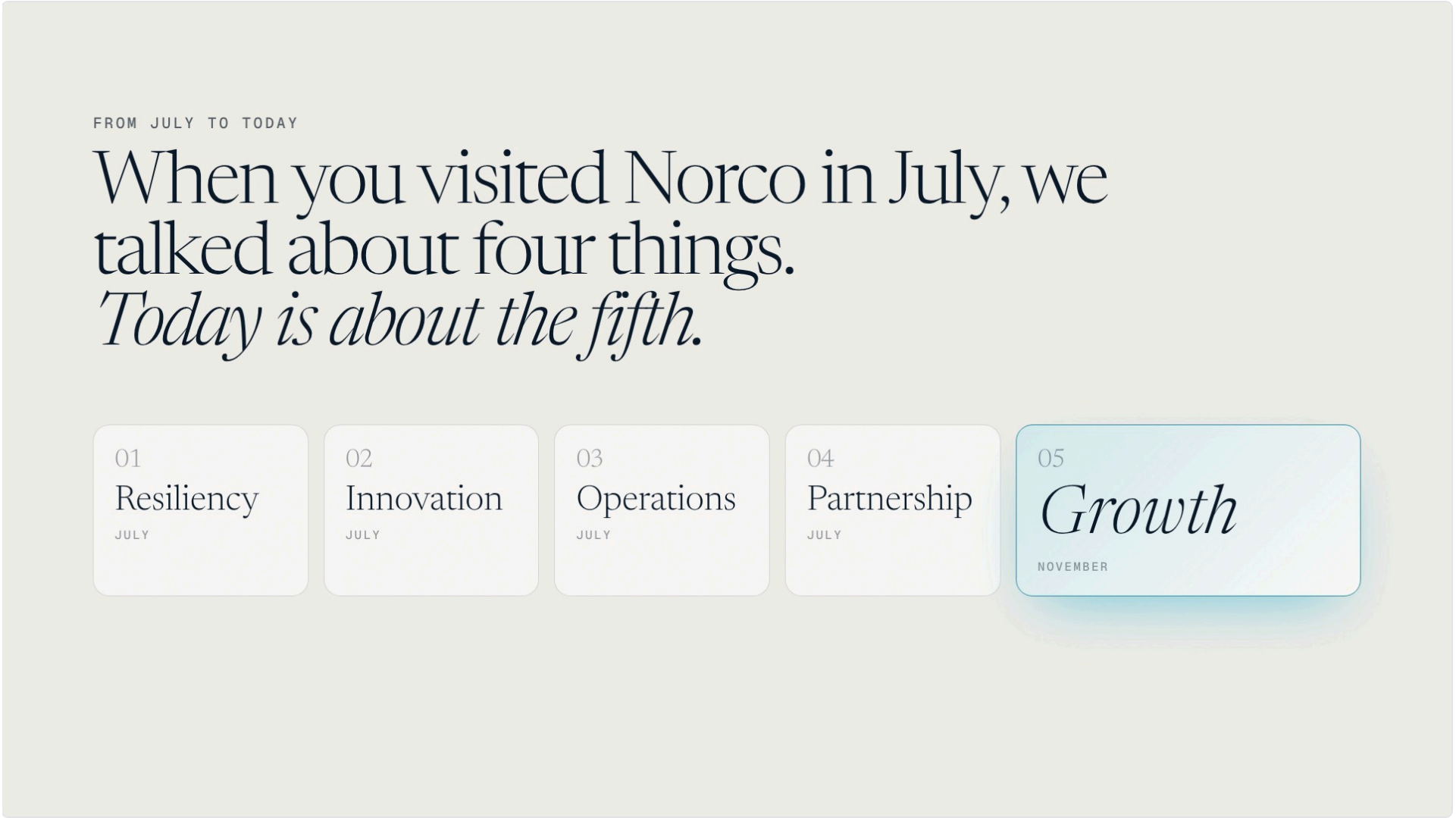
- 9:30. Ross is meeting us at 9:30 to help with the Wi-Fi and the room.
- Laptop on the TV, press F for full screen, and test the film sound.
- As people sit down, ask them to scan the code. Their names show up on screen as they join.



- 10:00. Welcome everyone and thank Ross for inviting us.
- Two hours: the four things Ross asked for, four samples to taste, and a plan to leave with.
- Phones come out a few times today, for votes and for the tasting.



- Introduce the four of us and what each of us does day to day.
- Ross asked to see our creativity, technical expertise and innovation capabilities. Today is our chance to show them.



- When they visited Norco in July we talked about resiliency, innovation, operations and partnership.
- Today is about the fifth one: growth.

FROM ROSS'S INVITATION

You asked for four things. *Here is when we get to each one.*

01

Identifying emerging flavor, sensory, and consumer trends that could influence the future of oral care.

10:10 TO 10:25
WHAT'S CHANGING

02

Exploring new flavor territories and sensory experiences that can differentiate TheraBreath from competitors and create memorable consumer experiences.

10:25 TO 11:00
WHERE FLAVOR COULD GO

03

Developing innovative flavor concepts that unlock new usage occasions, address new consumer segments, and create opportunities for portfolio expansion.

11:00 TO 11:20
WHAT WE COULD MAKE

04

Generating a pipeline of innovation platforms, flavor directions, and white-space opportunities that have the potential to drive incremental growth across the portfolio.

11:20 TO 11:40
WHAT TO DO FIRST

AND THE GOAL BEHIND THEM

"...new flavor experiences that both *strengthen our appeal with existing loyal users* and *create opportunities to attract new consumers to the franchise*."

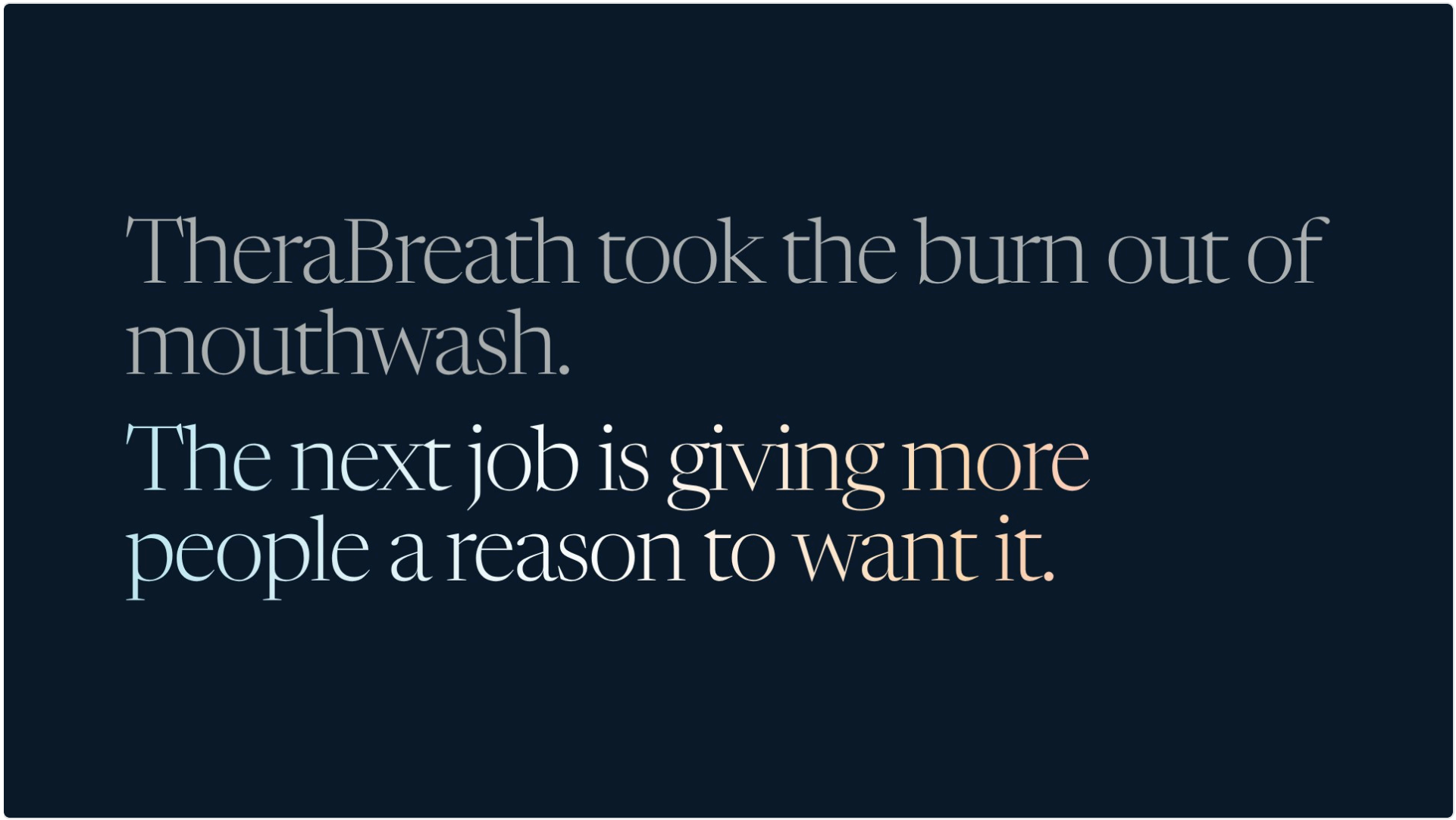
Source: Ross Conroy, Church & Dwight Oral Care R&D, workshop invitation, September 18, 2026

- Read the four objectives the way Ross wrote them. They are the agenda for the morning.
- Last build is his goal: flavors that keep loyal users and bring in new ones.

After 5 · Your pre-brief answers

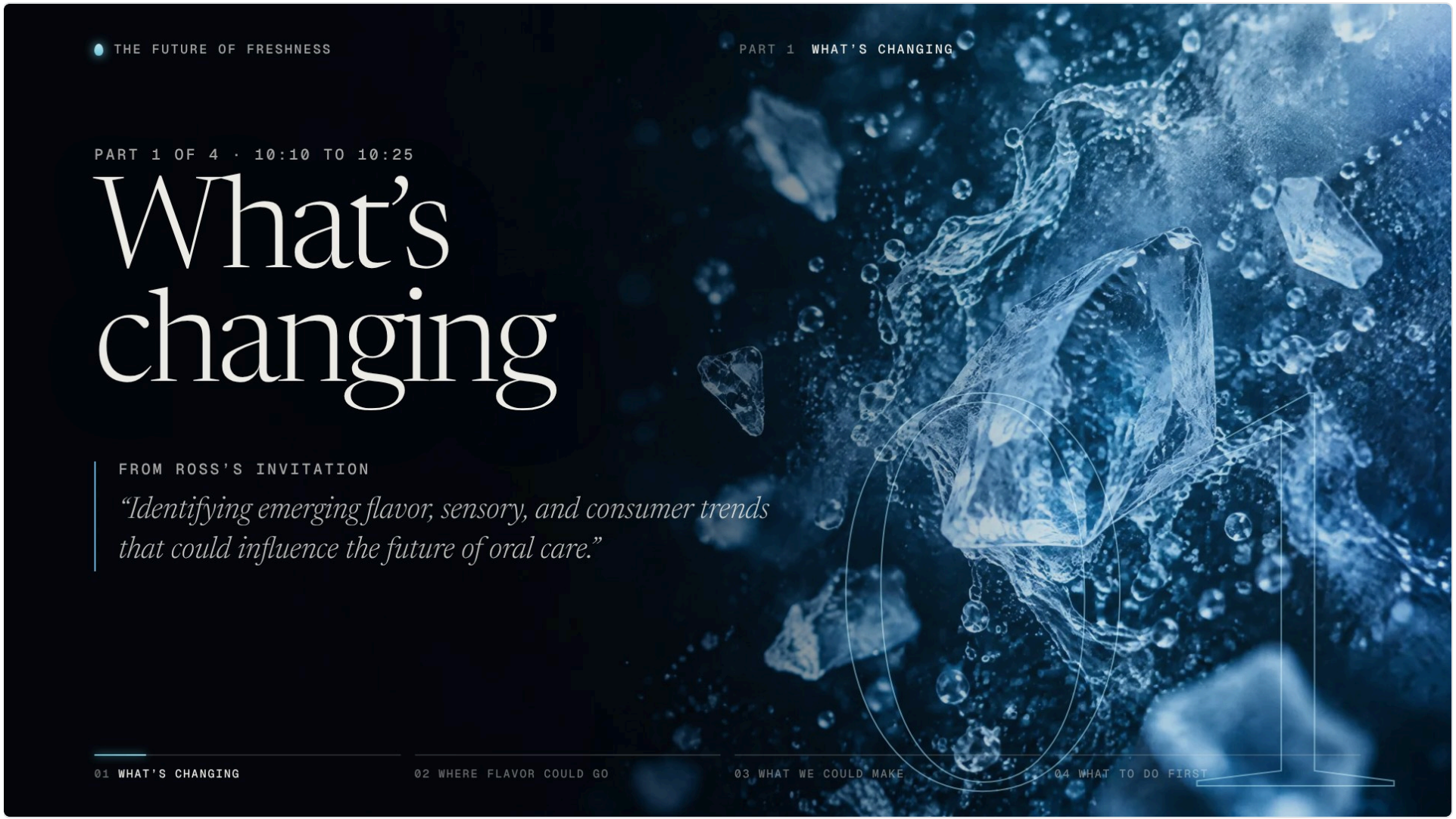
Appears here once the pre-brief answers are in (Ross sends the pre-brief on November 3): the consumer they most want TheraBreath to win, the moment TheraBreath is missing, and the flavors they would never approve, without names. Every scene after it is numbered one higher.

- The pre-brief answers: the consumer they most want to win, and the moment TheraBreath is missing.
- Have some fun with the vetoes. No names on screen.

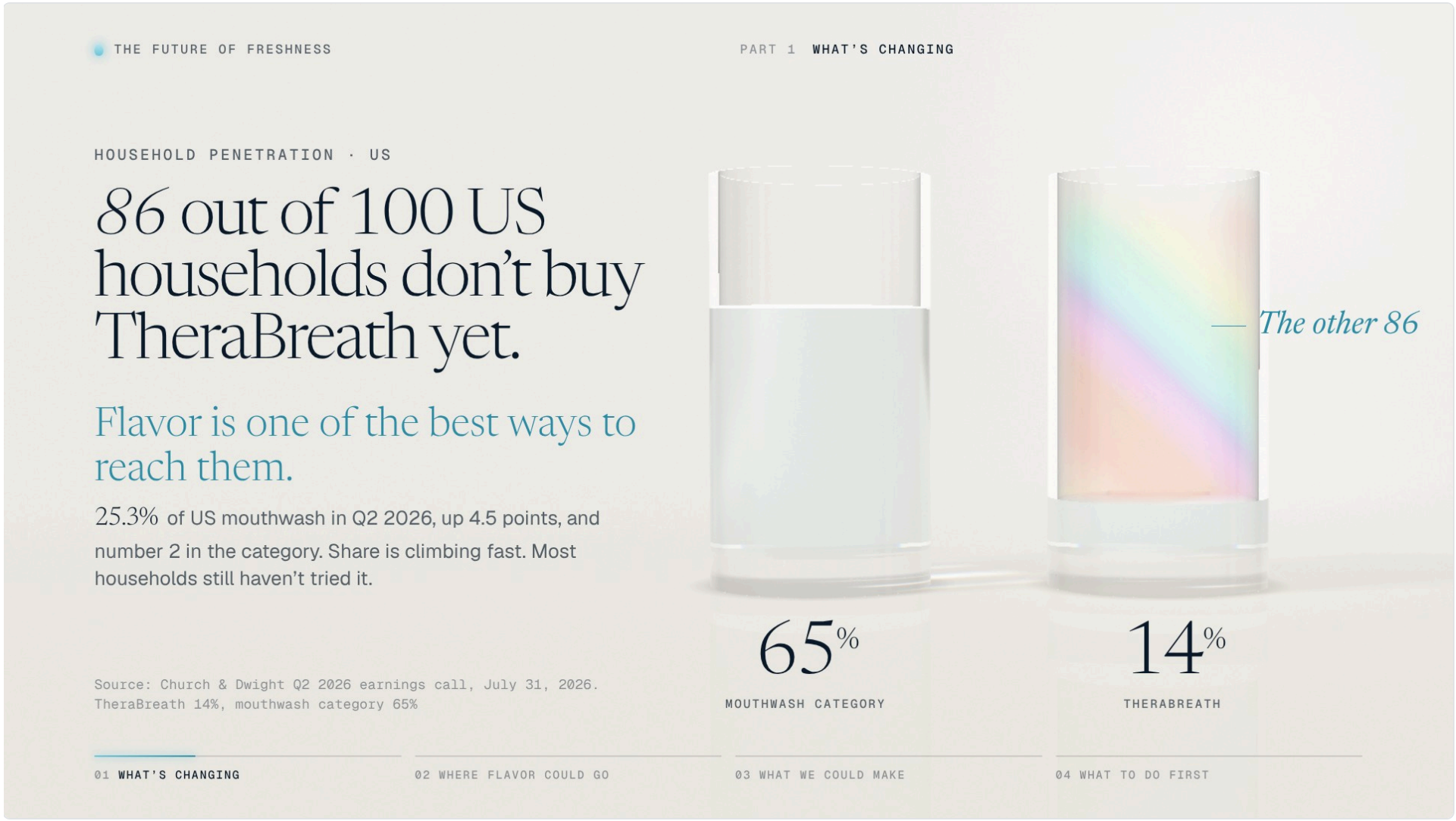


- Let this one sit for a second.

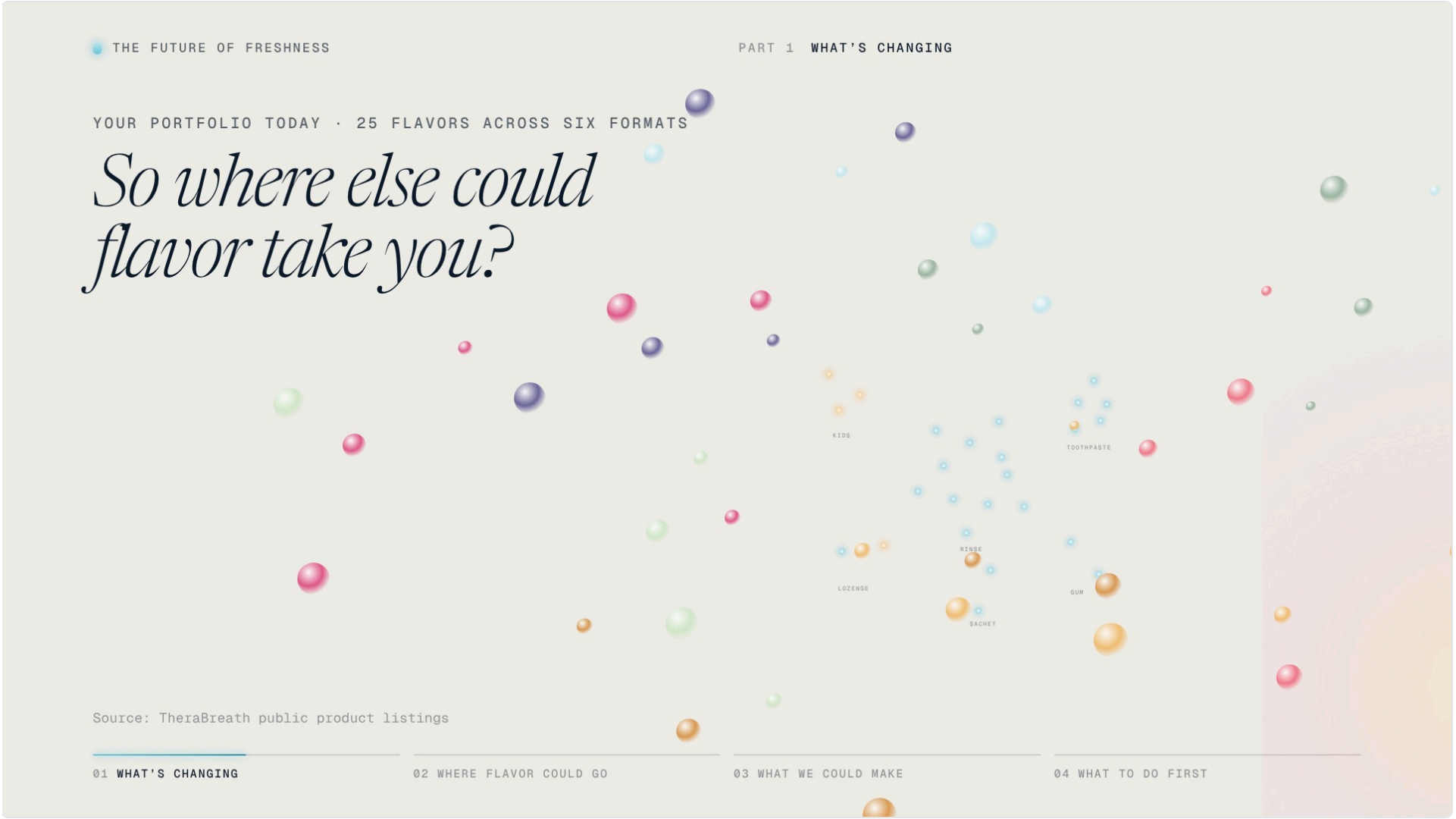
- TheraBreath took the burn out of mouthwash. The next job is giving more people a reason to want it.



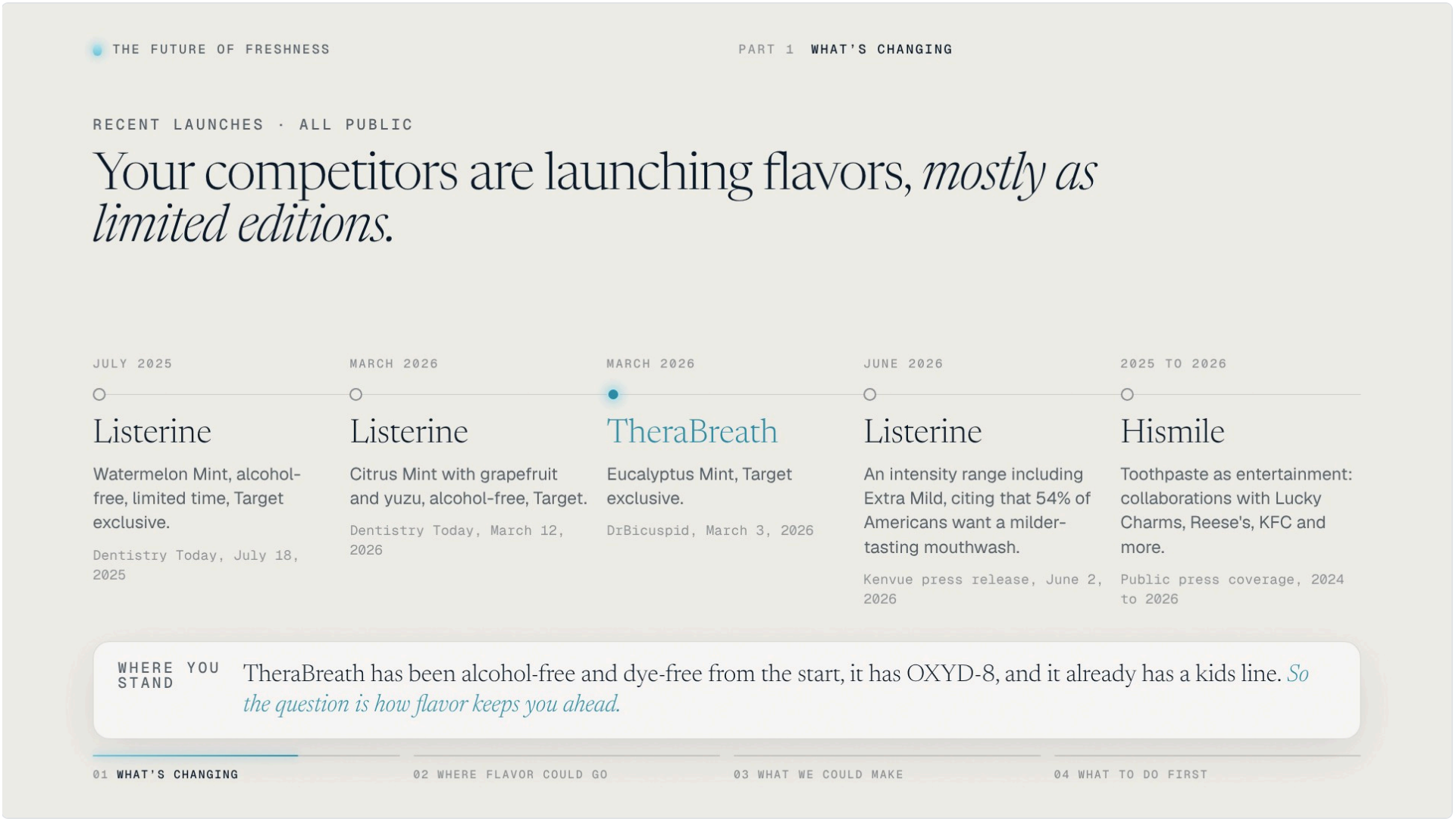
- Read Ross’s words on screen, then talk it through:
- 21 of TheraBreath’s 25 flavors are mint.
- 86 out of 100 US households don’t buy TheraBreath yet.
- Competitors are adding flavors, mostly as limited editions.
- Seven trends we think matter for oral care.



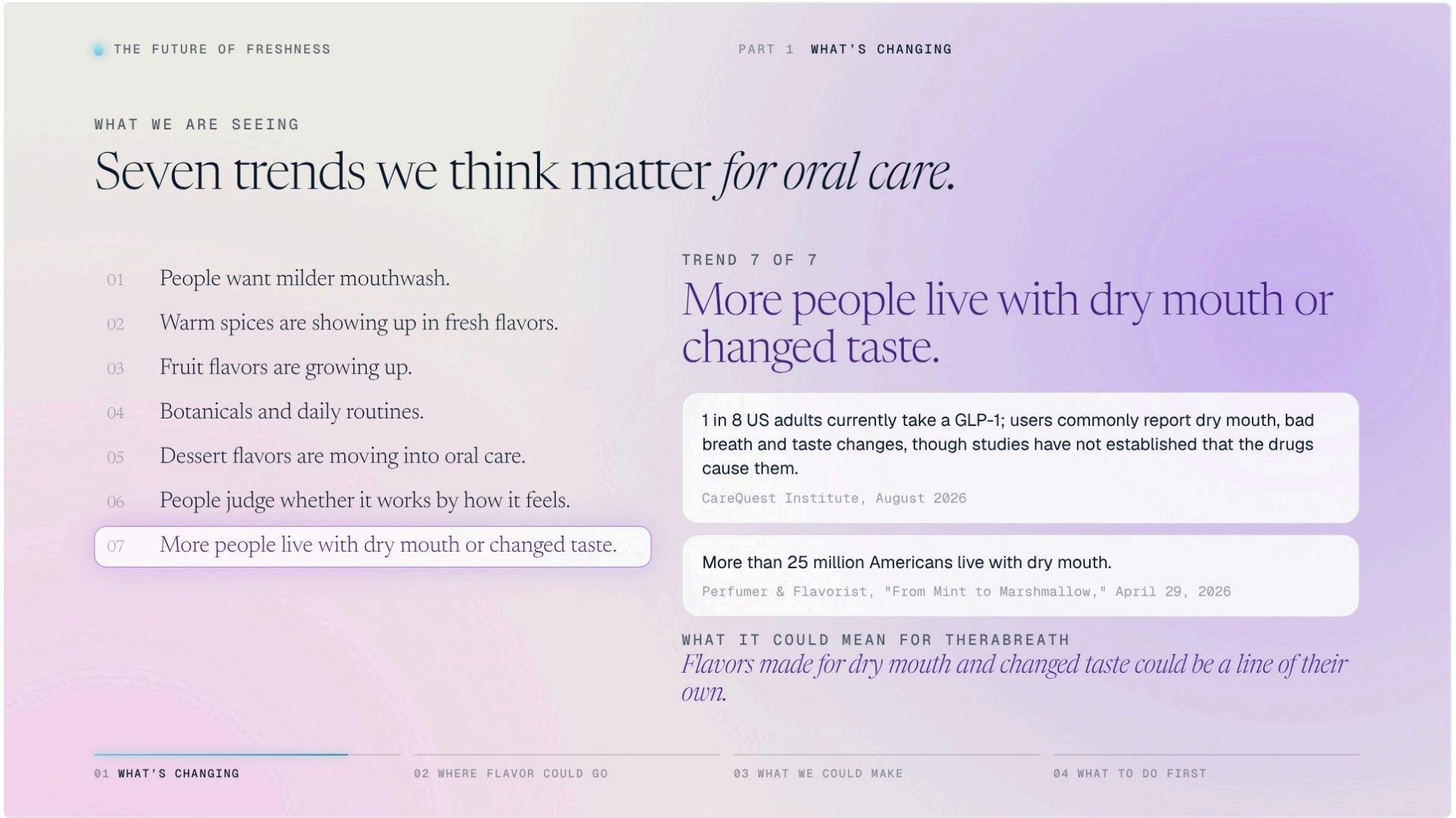
- Quick context first: 25.3% of US mouthwash in Q2 2026, up 4.5 points, number 2.
- Then let the glasses fill. 86 out of 100 US households still don't buy TheraBreath.
- Flavor is one of the best ways to reach them.



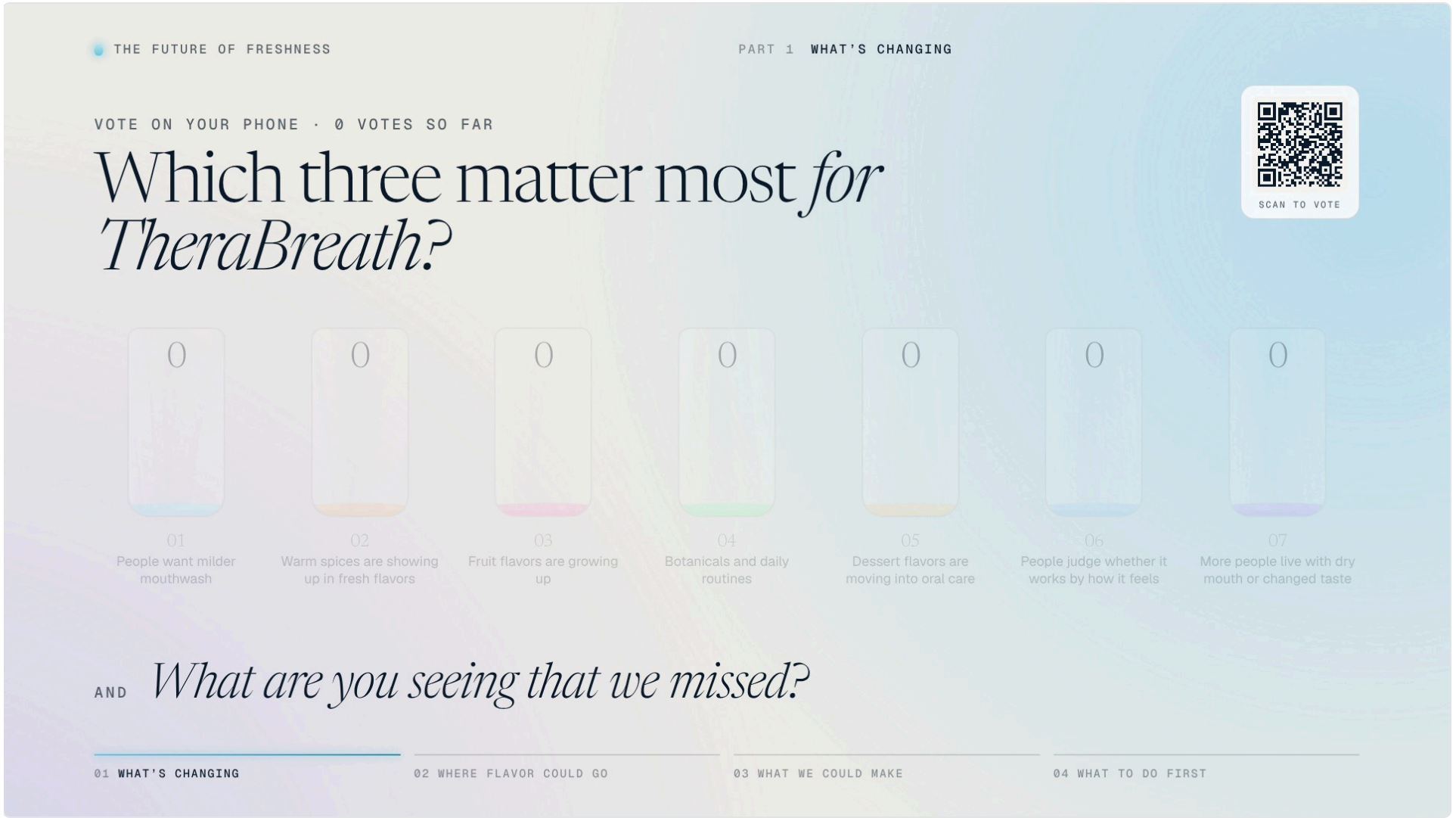
- 21 of the 25 flavors are mint. That is a strength.
- Next build zooms out: there is a lot of room around mint.



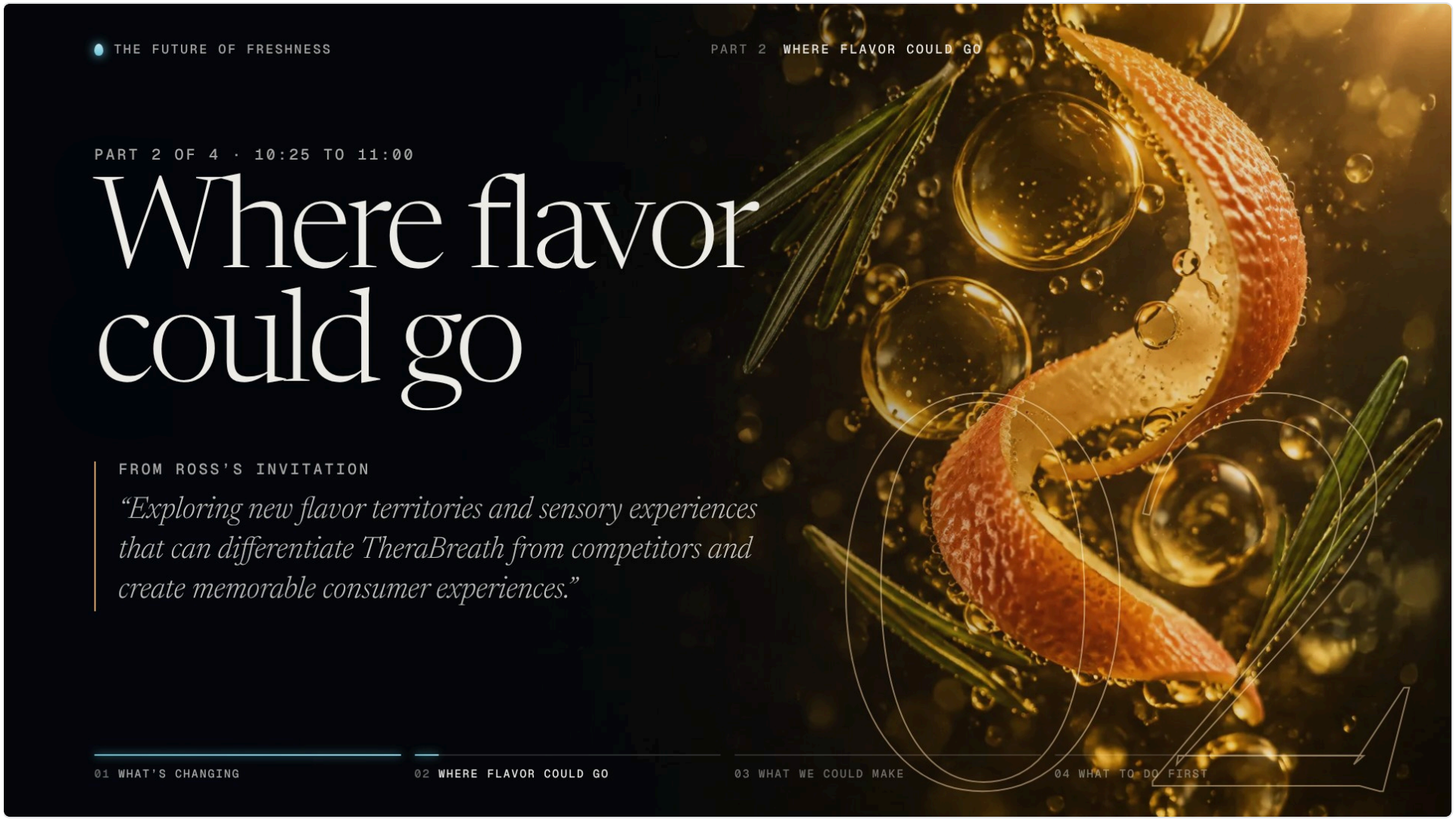
- Keep this factual. Competitors are adding flavors, mostly as limited editions.
- Last build: TheraBreath already has what they are chasing (alcohol-free, dye-free, OXYD-8, a kids line). Ask what keeps it ahead.



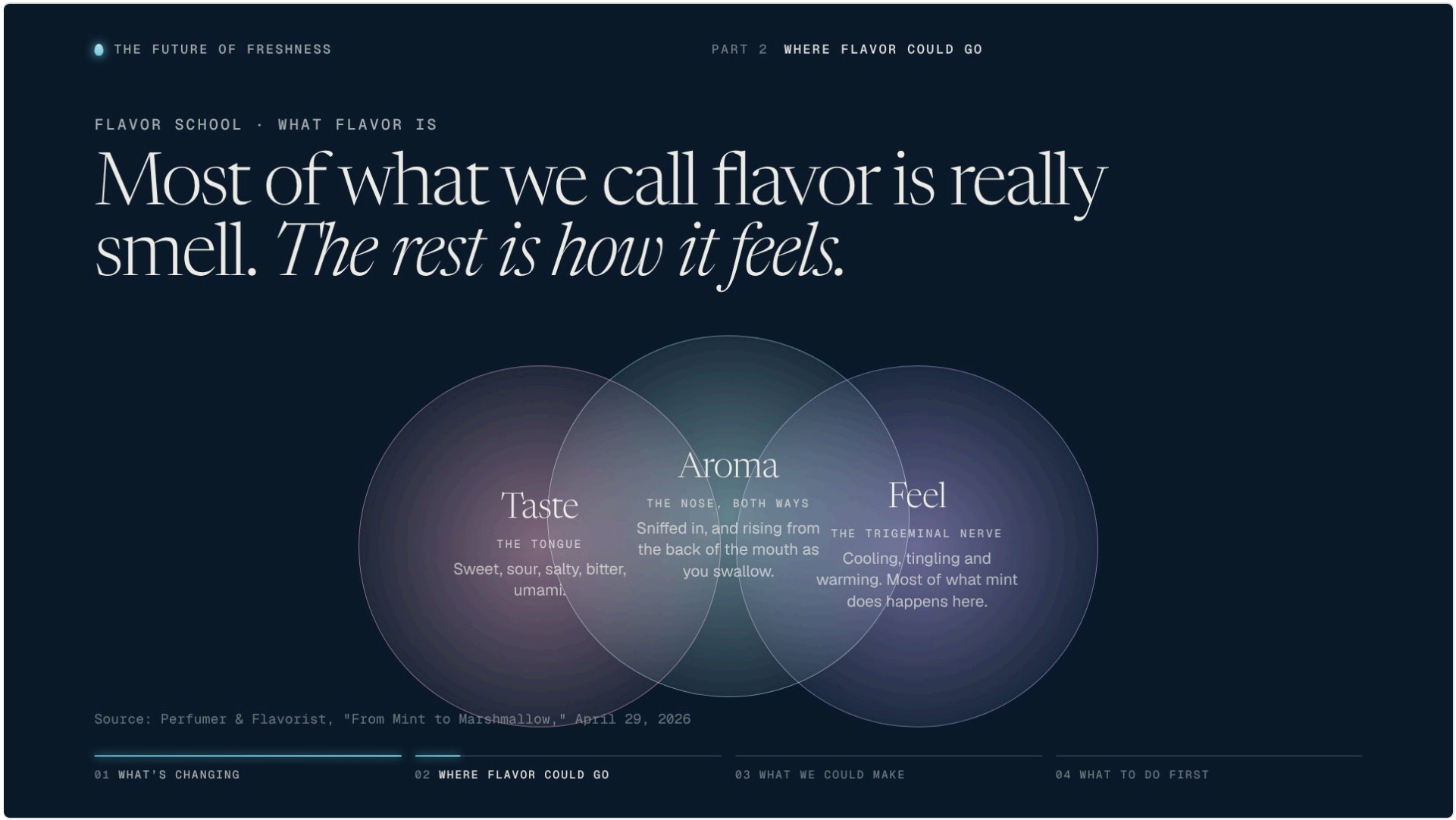
- One trend per click: the headline, two sources, and what we think it means for TheraBreath.
- Don't read every source out loud. About forty seconds each.
- Ask which one surprises them.



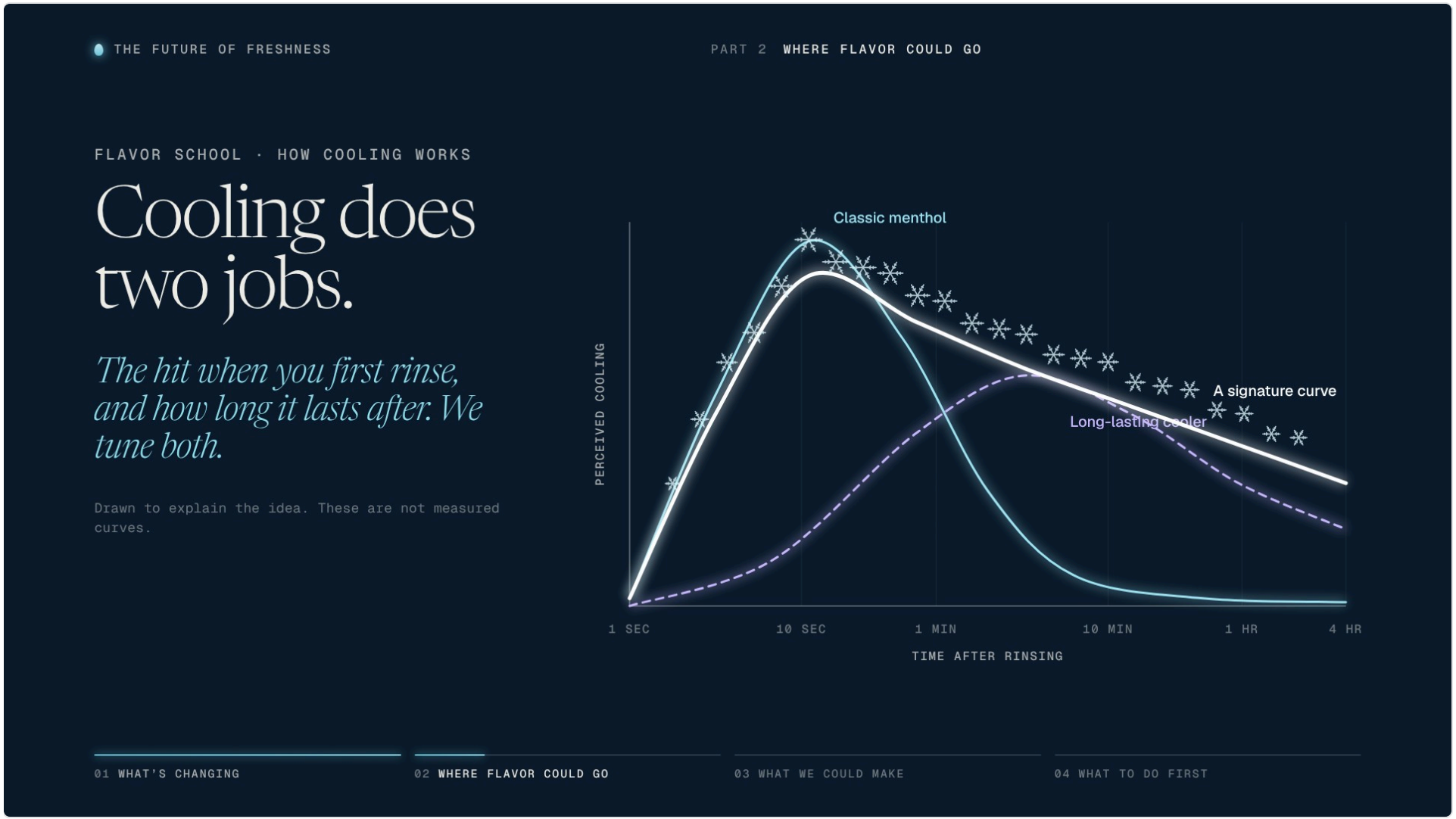
- Phones out. Everyone picks three.
- Watch the bars fill. No phone? Click a bar to add a hand vote.
- Build 1 shows the top three. They go into the Playbook.
- Build 2: What are you seeing that we missed?



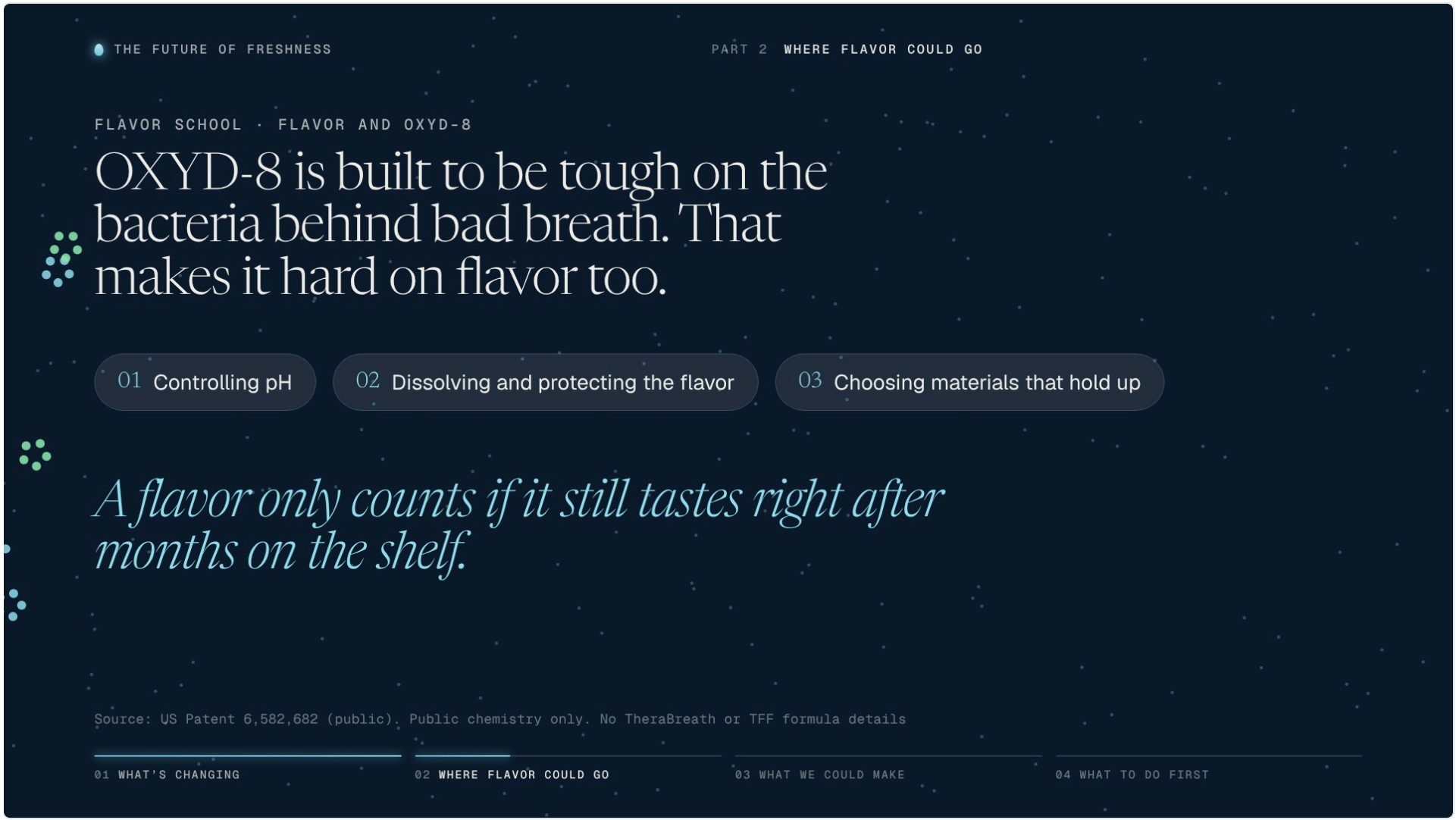
- Read Ross's words on screen, then talk it through:
- Most of what people call flavor is smell. The rest is how it feels.
- OXYD-8 is hard on flavor, so everything we make has to hold up in it.
- Four directions. Two of them are in the tasting.
- Four samples, made in your Fresh Breath and Kids bases.



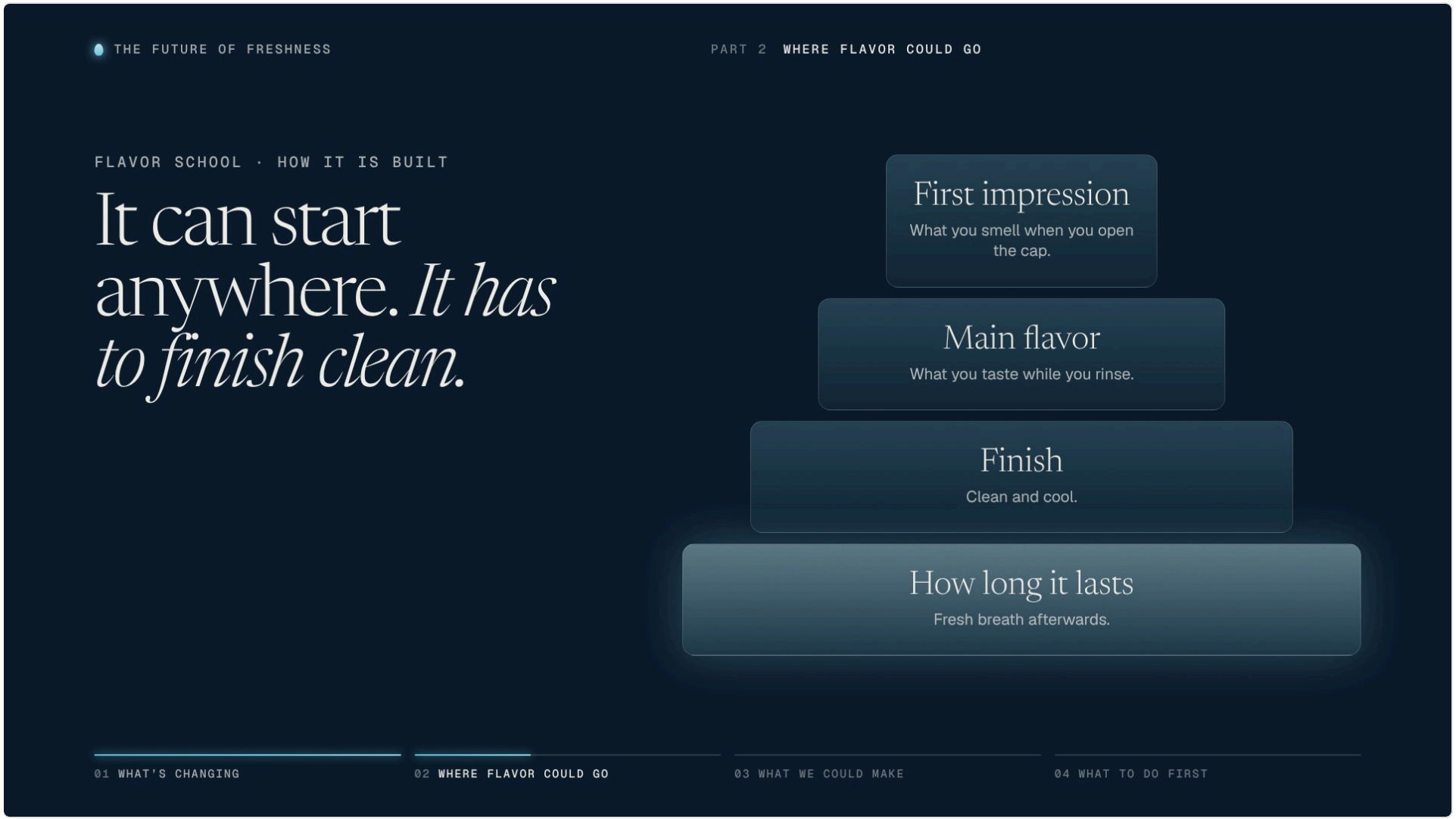
- Taste is the tongue: sweet, sour, salty, bitter, umami.
- Aroma is the nose, including from the back of the mouth when you swallow.
- Feel is the trigeminal nerve. That is where cooling, tingle and warmth come from.



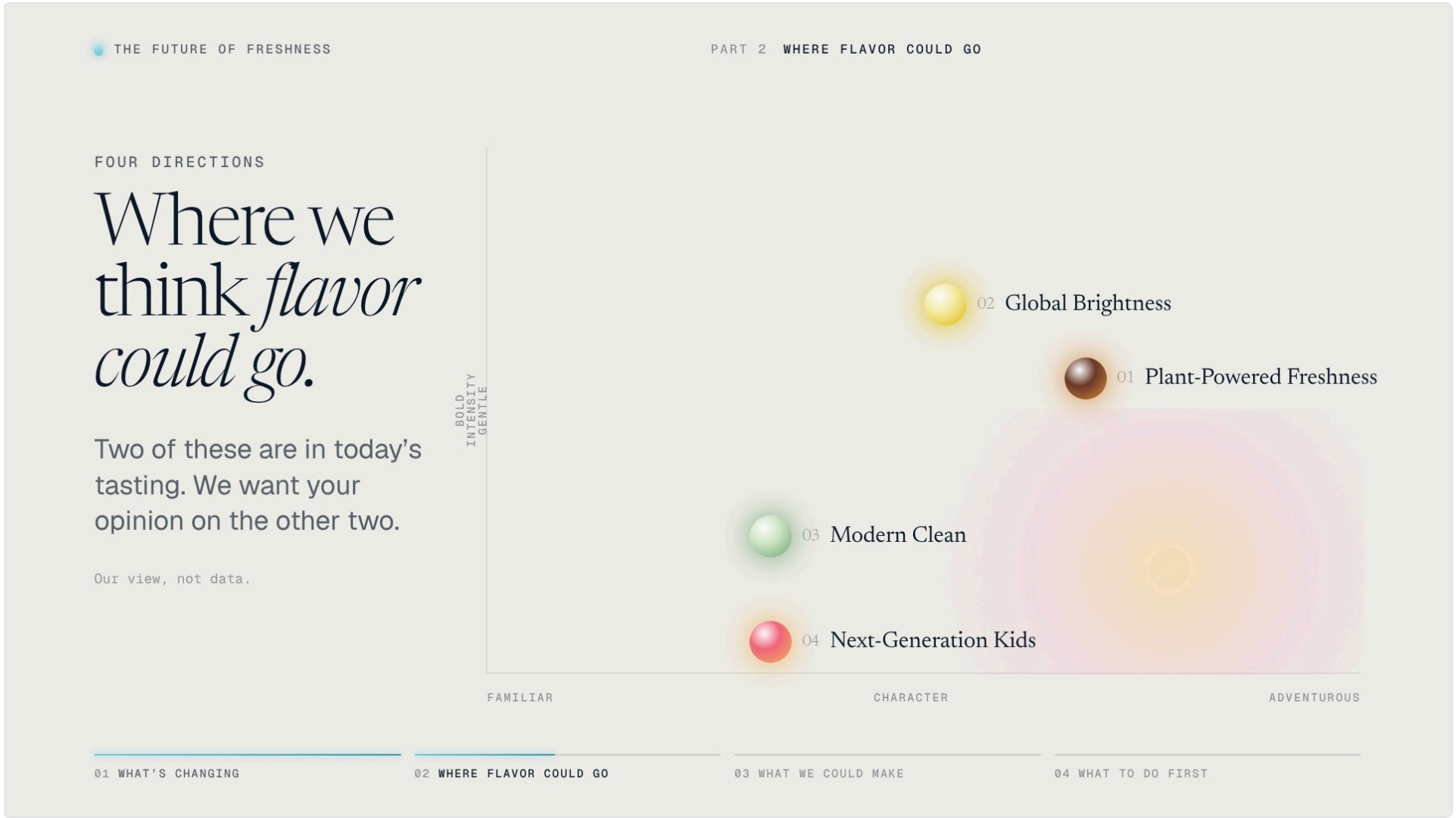
- Cooling does two jobs: the hit when you first rinse, and how long it lasts.
- These curves are for explaining, not measured data.



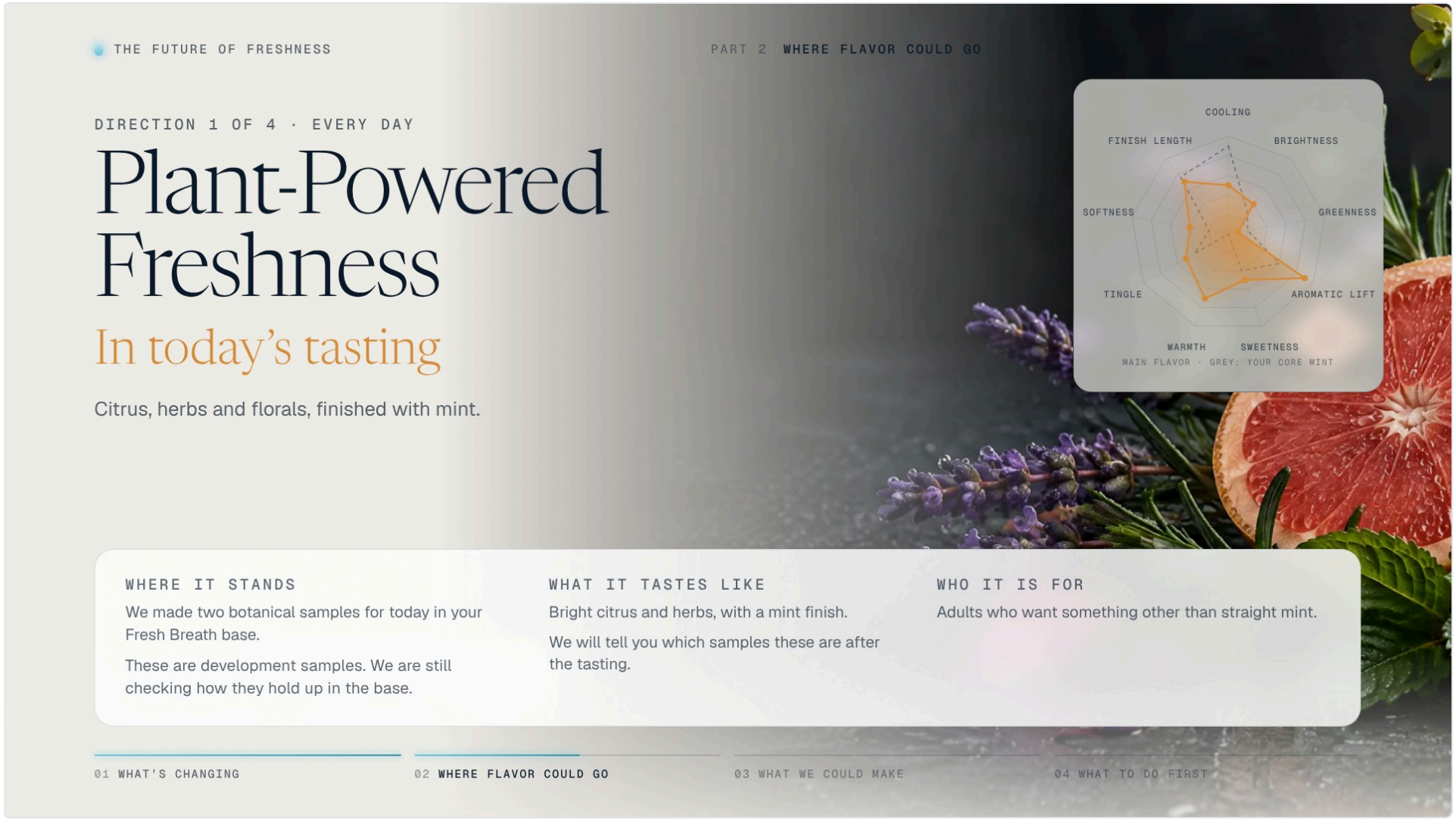
- OXYD-8 is tough on the bacteria behind bad breath, and that makes it hard on flavor.
- Three things we work with: pH, how we dissolve and protect the flavor, and picking materials that hold up.
- Public chemistry only. No formula details.



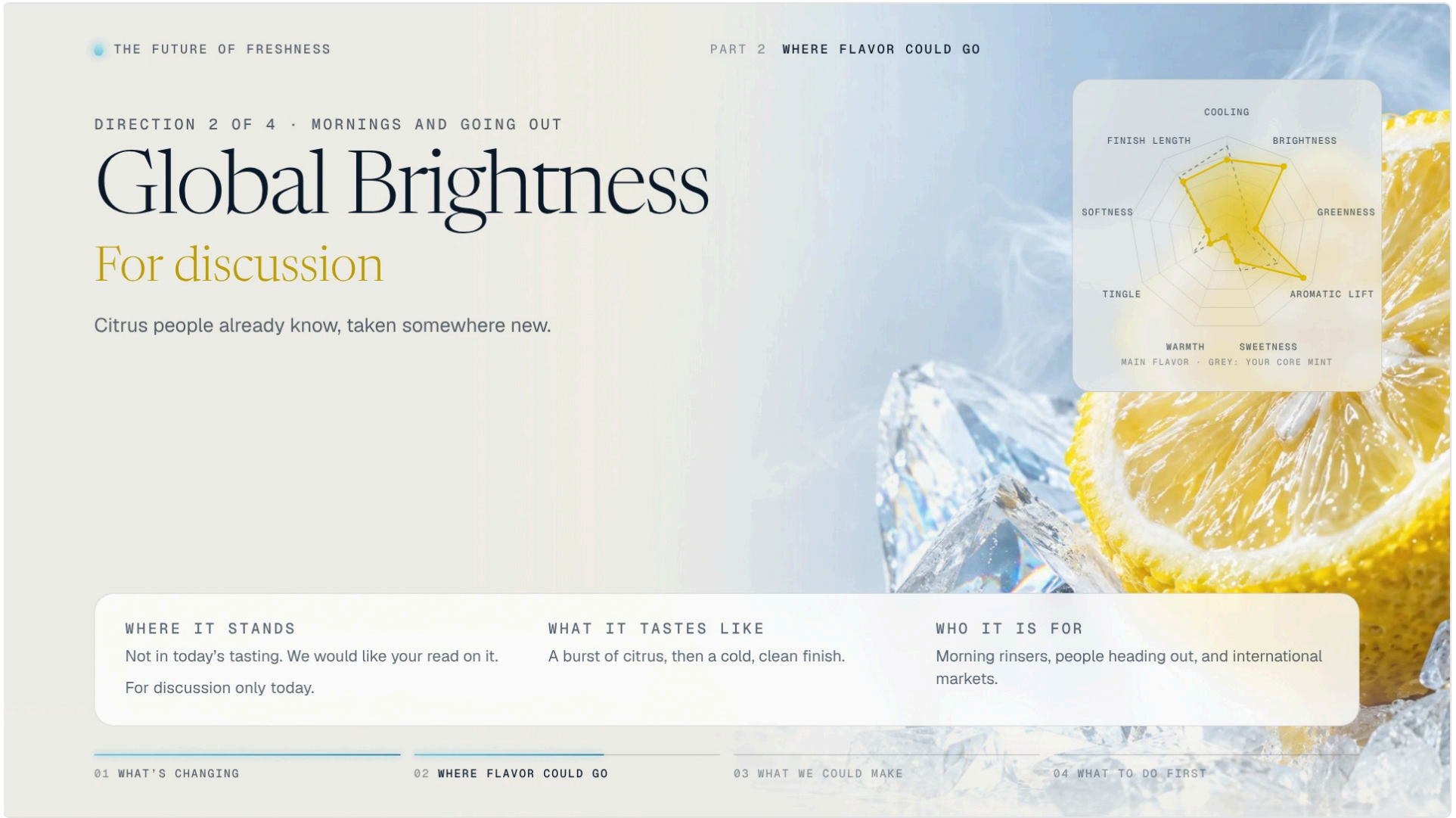
- First impression, main flavor, finish, and how long it lasts.
- Whatever it starts with, a TheraBreath flavor has to finish clean.



- Four directions on one map: familiar to adventurous, gentle to bold. This is our view, not data.
- The gentle and adventurous corner is where we think new users could come from.
- Two of these are in today's tasting.



- Plant-Powered Freshness: Citrus, herbs and florals, finished with mint.
- Two of today's samples come from here. Don't name them yet.
- Ask: Which of the two feels more like TheraBreath?



- Global Brightness: Citrus people already know, taken somewhere new.
- Not in the tasting. We just want their opinion.
- Ask: Is there a citrus flavor that could sit next to your mints?

THE FUTURE OF FRESHNESS

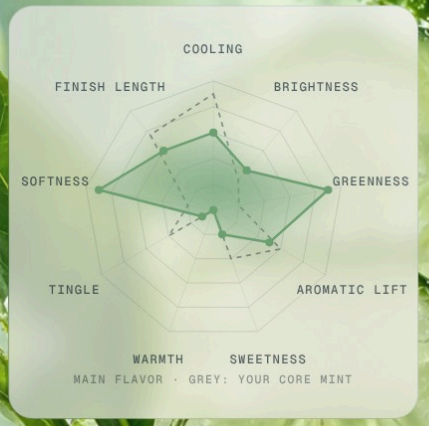
PART 2 WHERE FLAVOR COULD GO

DIRECTION 3 OF 4 · MIDDAY

Modern Clean

For discussion

Green, gentle freshness for people who find mouthwash too strong.



WHERE IT STANDS

Not in today's tasting. It would need consumer testing in your base.

For discussion only today.

WHAT IT TASTES LIKE

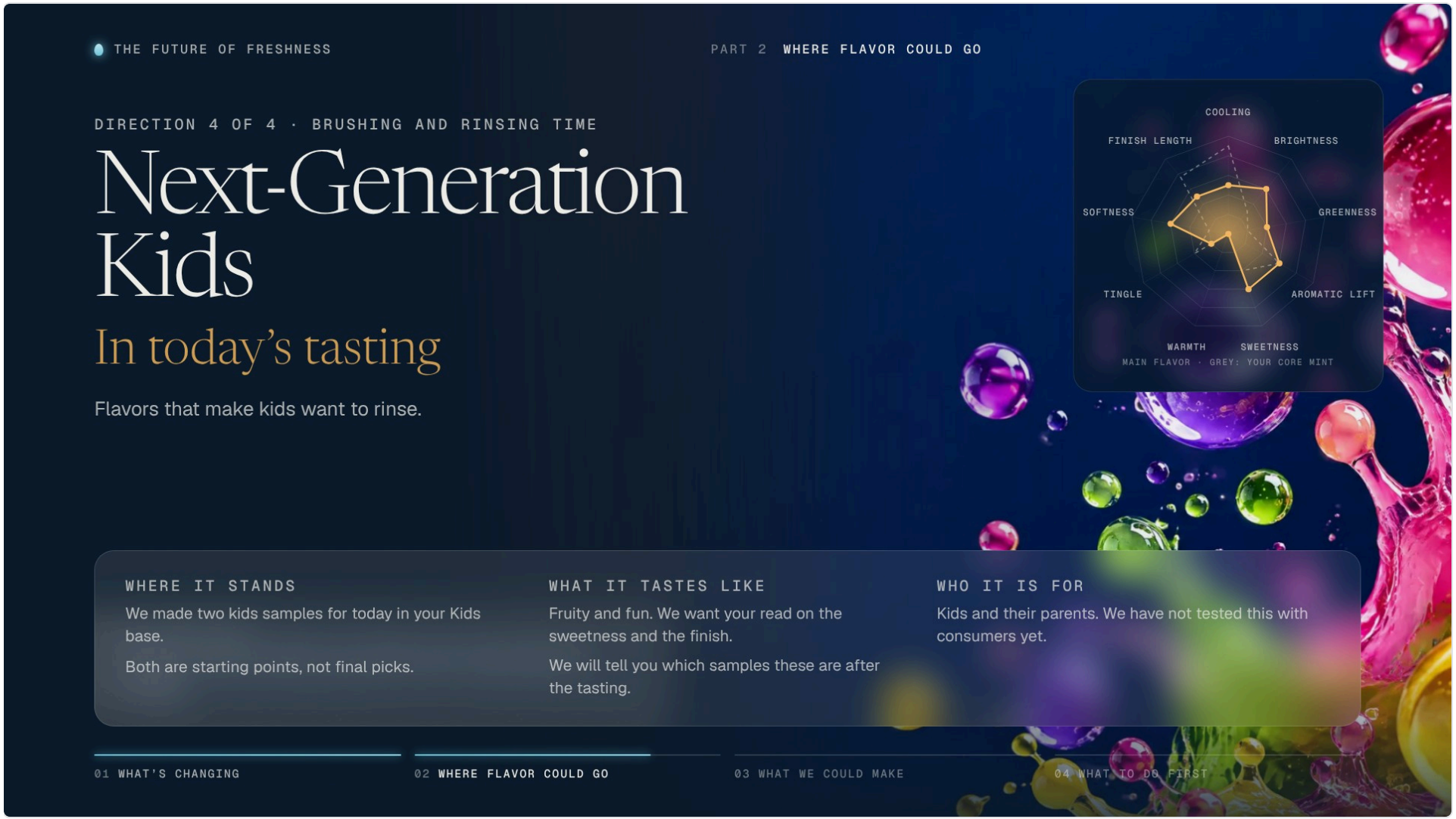
Soft cooling, green notes and a calm finish.

WHO IT IS FOR

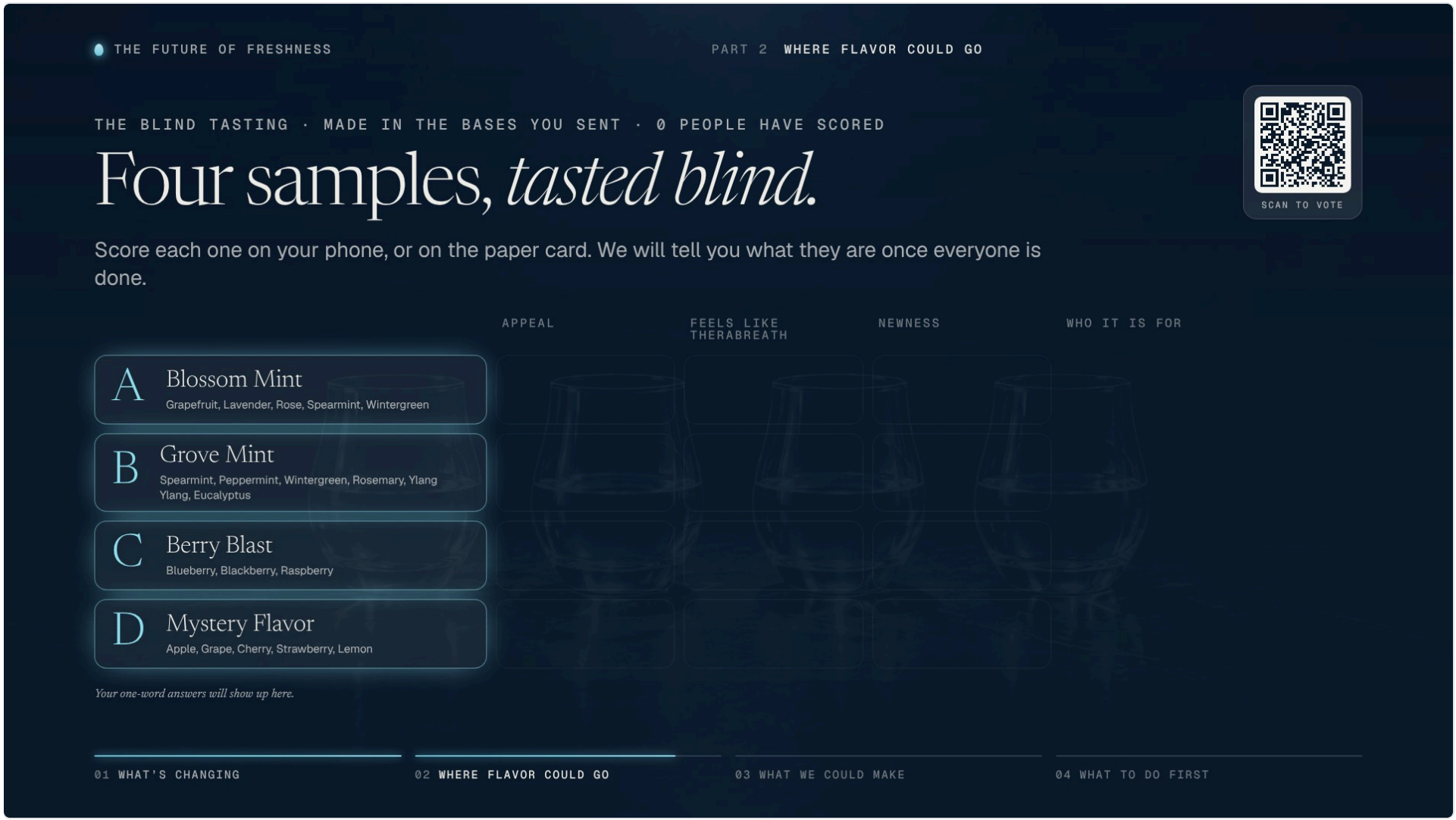
People who skip mouthwash because it is too harsh.

01 WHAT'S CHANGING | 02 WHERE FLAVOR COULD GO | 03 WHAT WE COULD MAKE | 04 WHAT TO DO FIRST

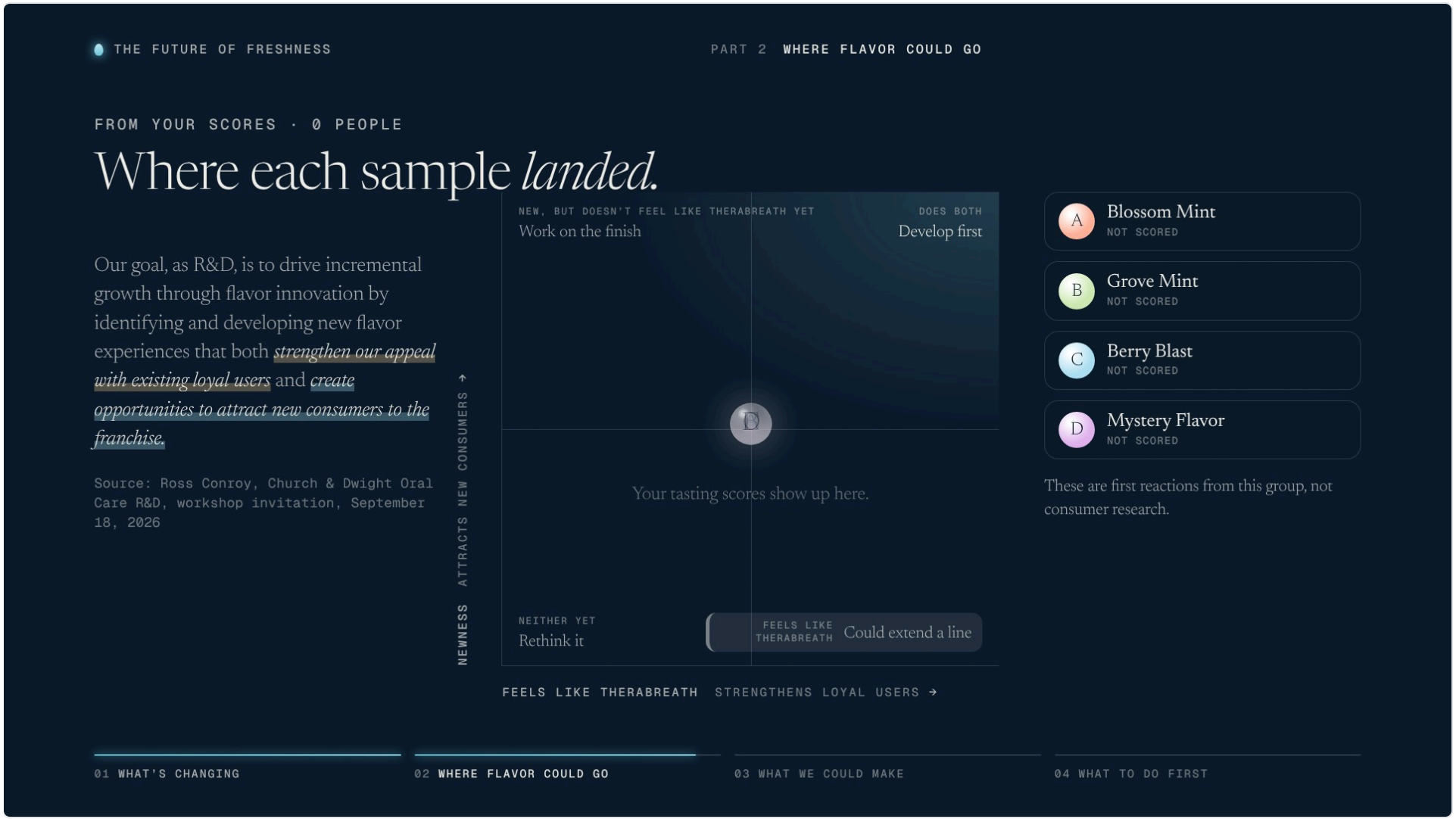
- Modern Clean: Green, gentle freshness for people who find mouthwash too strong.
- Not in the tasting. We just want their opinion.
- Ask: Can a gentle flavor still feel fresh enough?



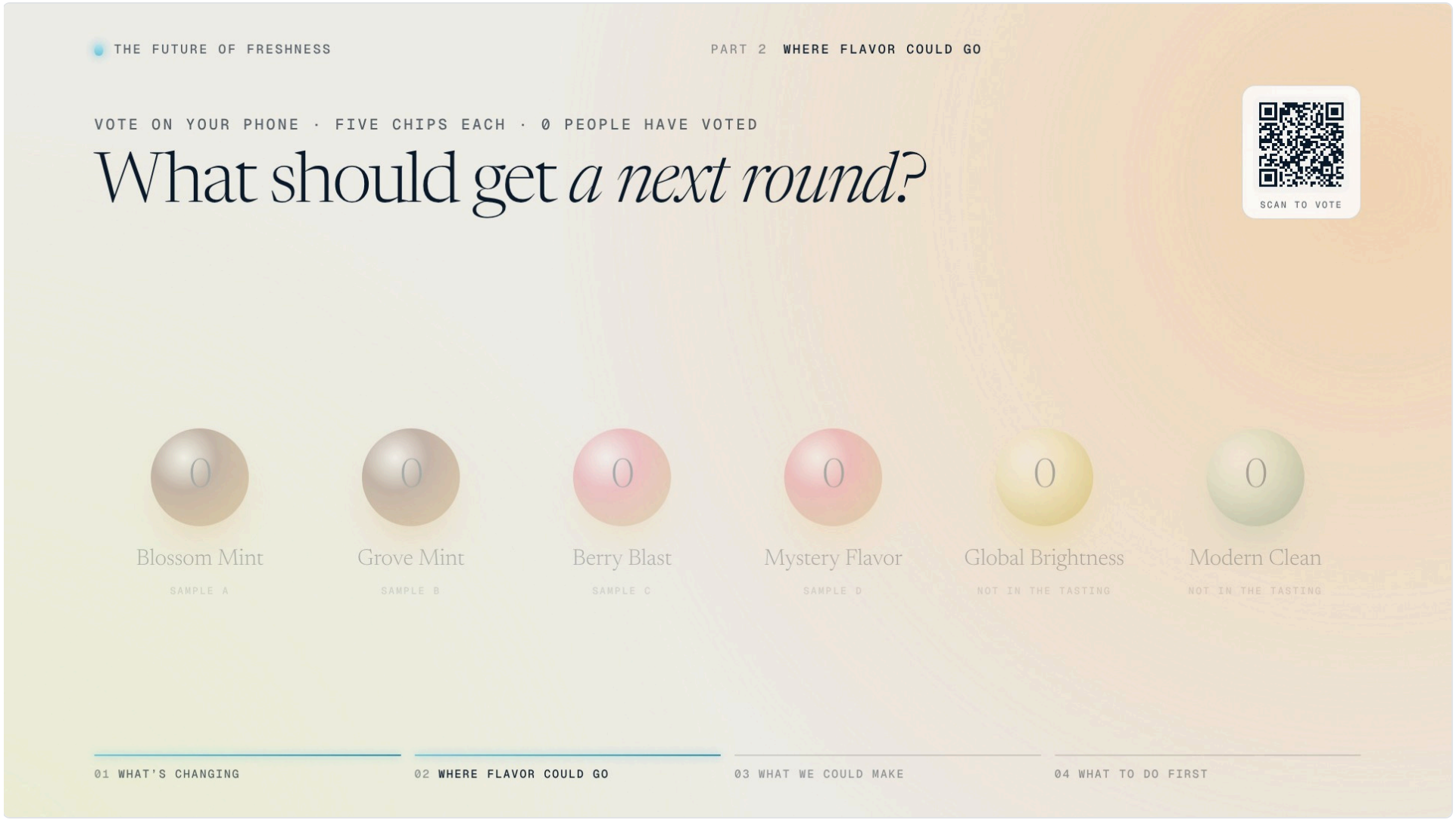
- Next-Generation Kids: Flavors that make kids want to rinse.
- Two of today's samples come from here. Don't name them yet.
- Ask: Would a mystery flavor get kids more interested in rinsing?



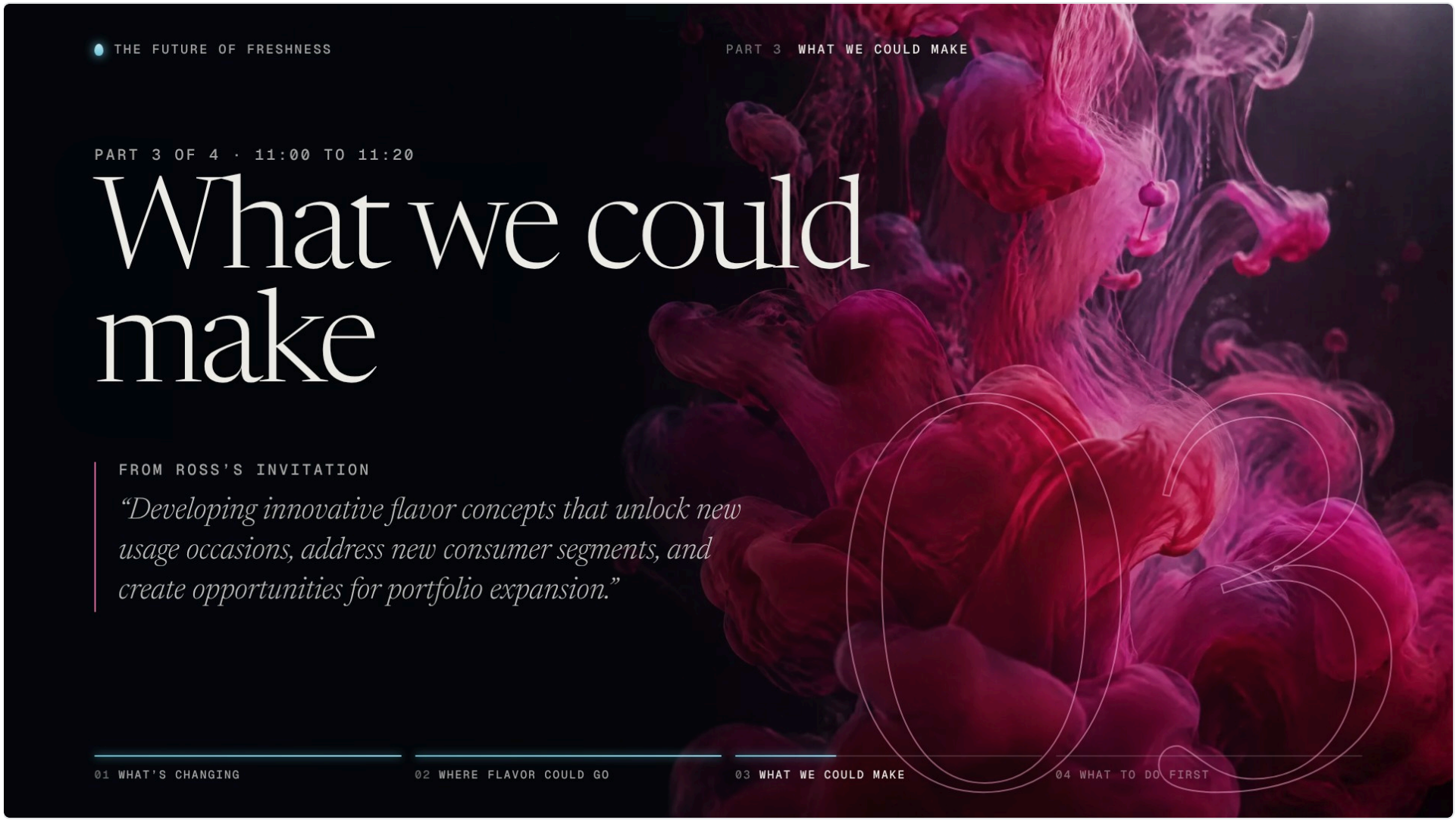
- Phones out, or the paper card. Score each sample as you go.
- A and B are in the Fresh Breath base, C and D in the Kids base.
- D is the Mystery Flavor. Taste it last and write down the fruits.
- Water and a pause between samples. These are first reactions, not consumer research.
- Build 1 shows their words and fruit guesses. Build 2 reveals the names.



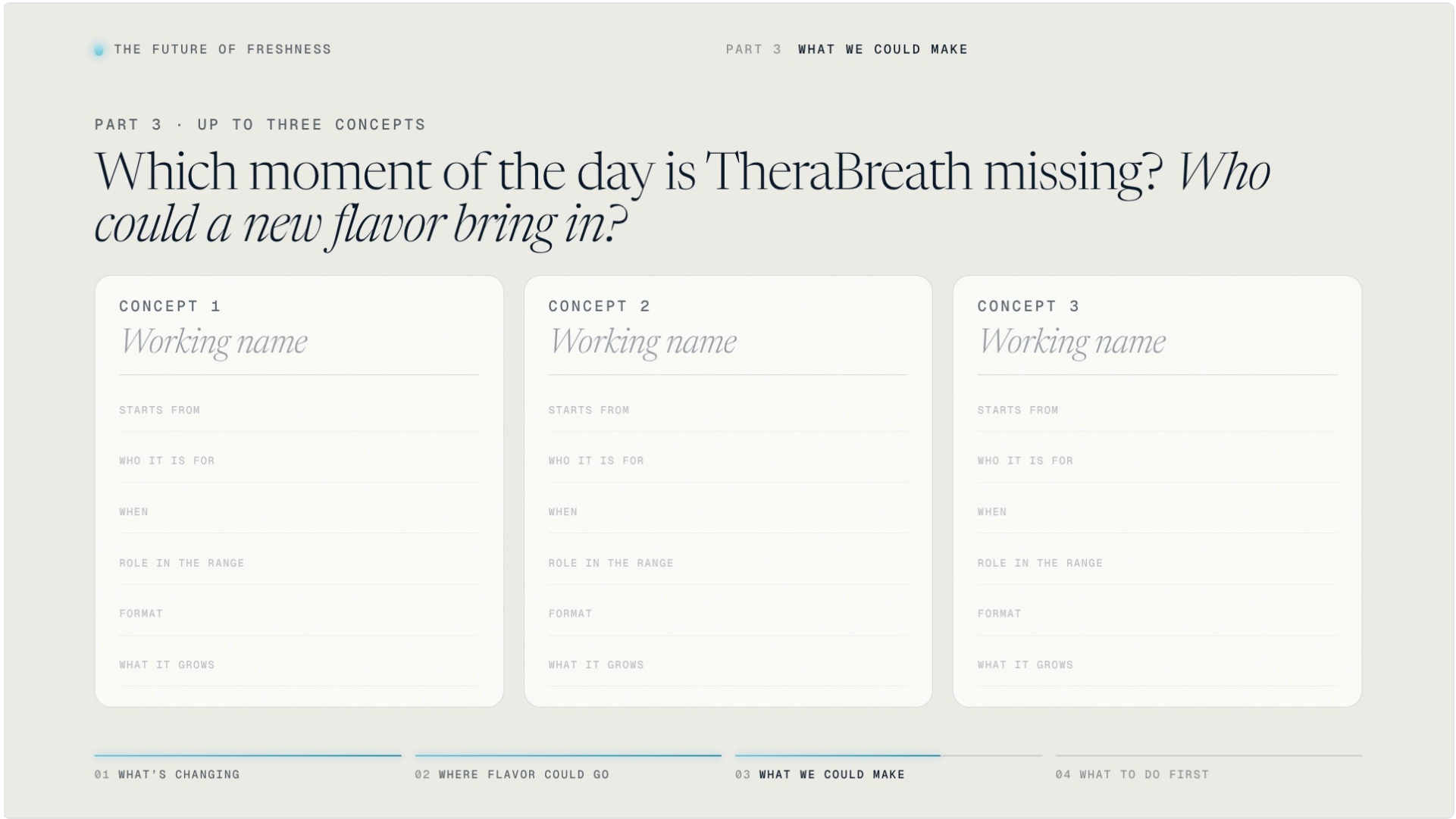
- This comes straight from their scores. Across: feels like TheraBreath (loyal users). Up: newness (new consumers). Size is appeal.
- Top right is what Ross asked for: both at once.



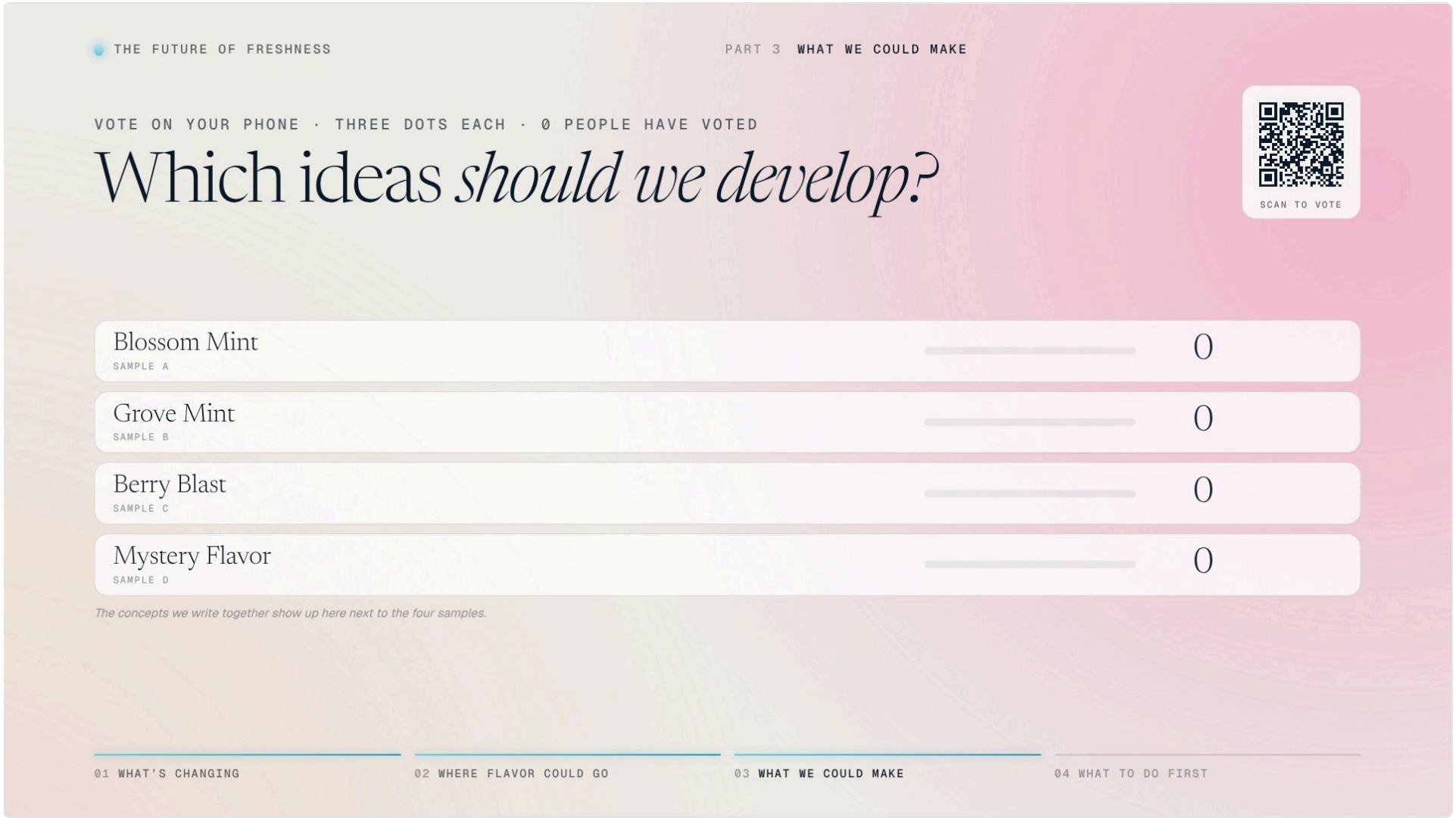
- Five chips each, on the samples and directions they would develop next. Stacking is fine.
- Click a direction to add a hand vote for anyone without a phone.
- Build 1 shows the top three.
- Then ask: What would make TheraBreath's flavors different from what competitors are launching?



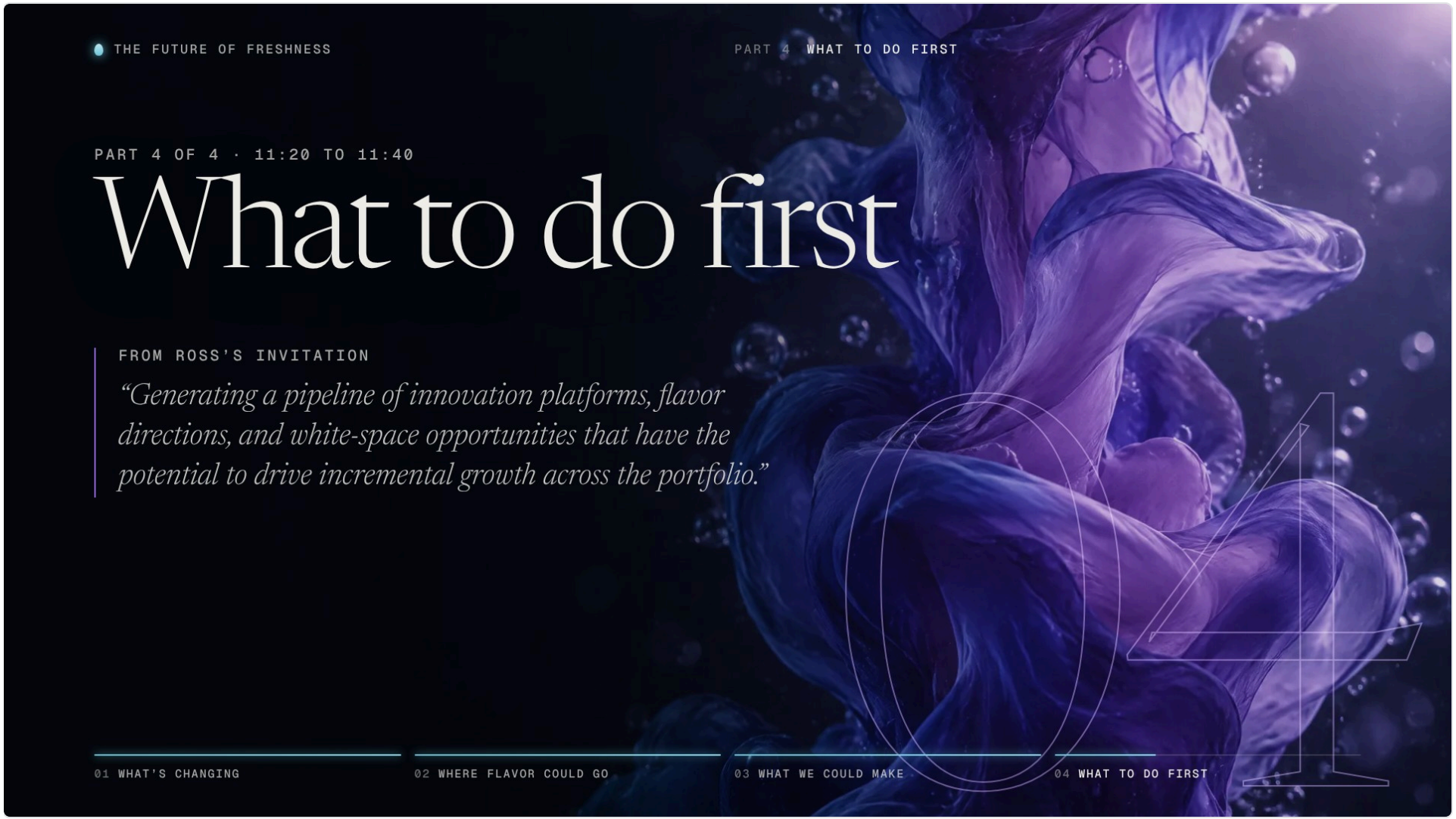
- Read Ross's words on screen, then talk it through:
- Start from the samples and directions that did well.
- For each concept: who it is for, when they would use it, its role in the range, the format, and what it grows.
- Up to three concepts.



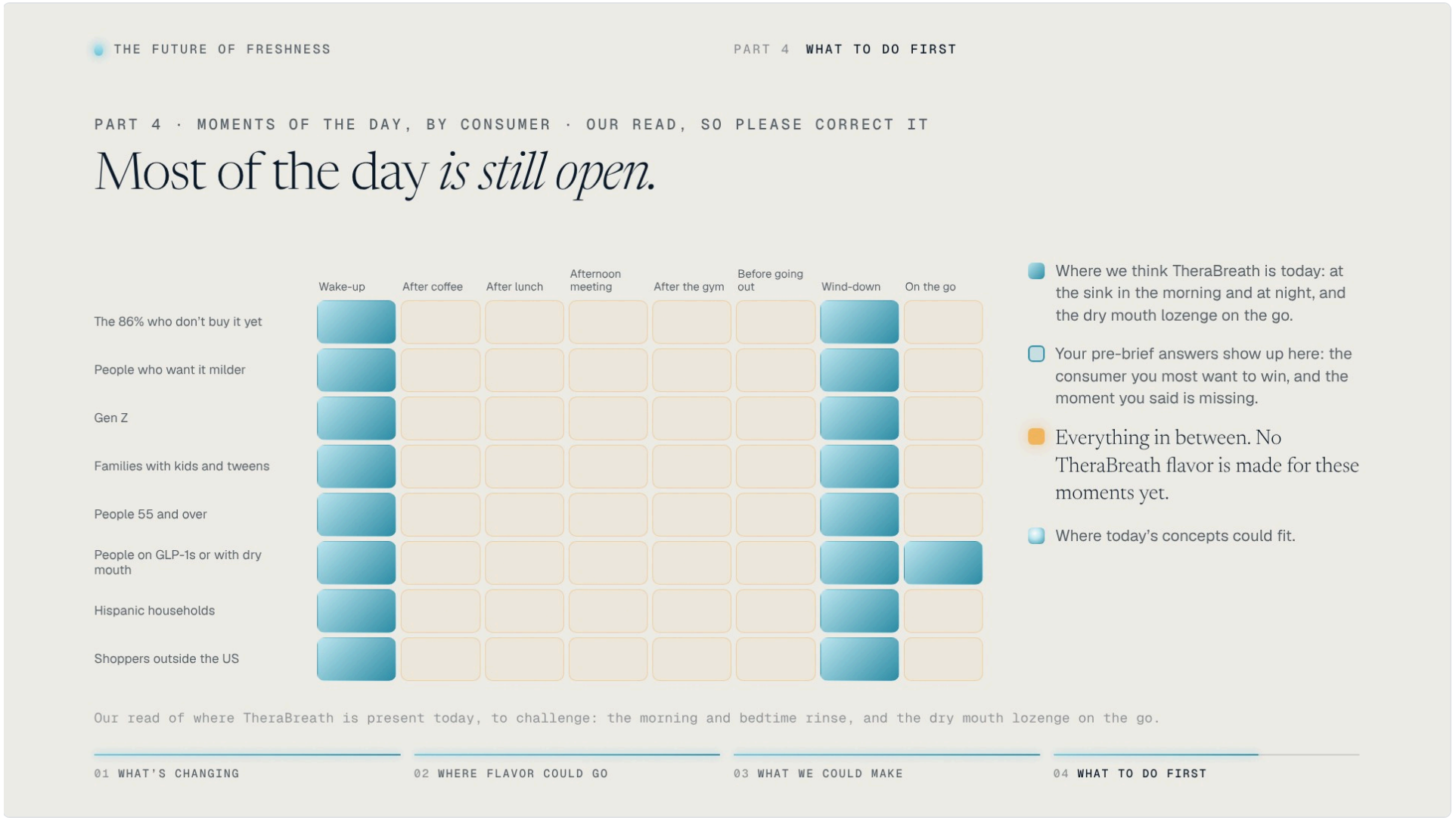
- Start from what scored well and what got chips.
- Up to three concepts. For each: where it starts, who it is for, when, its role in the range, the format, and what it grows.
- Type as they talk. The boxes suggest options from this morning, and everything saves to the session.



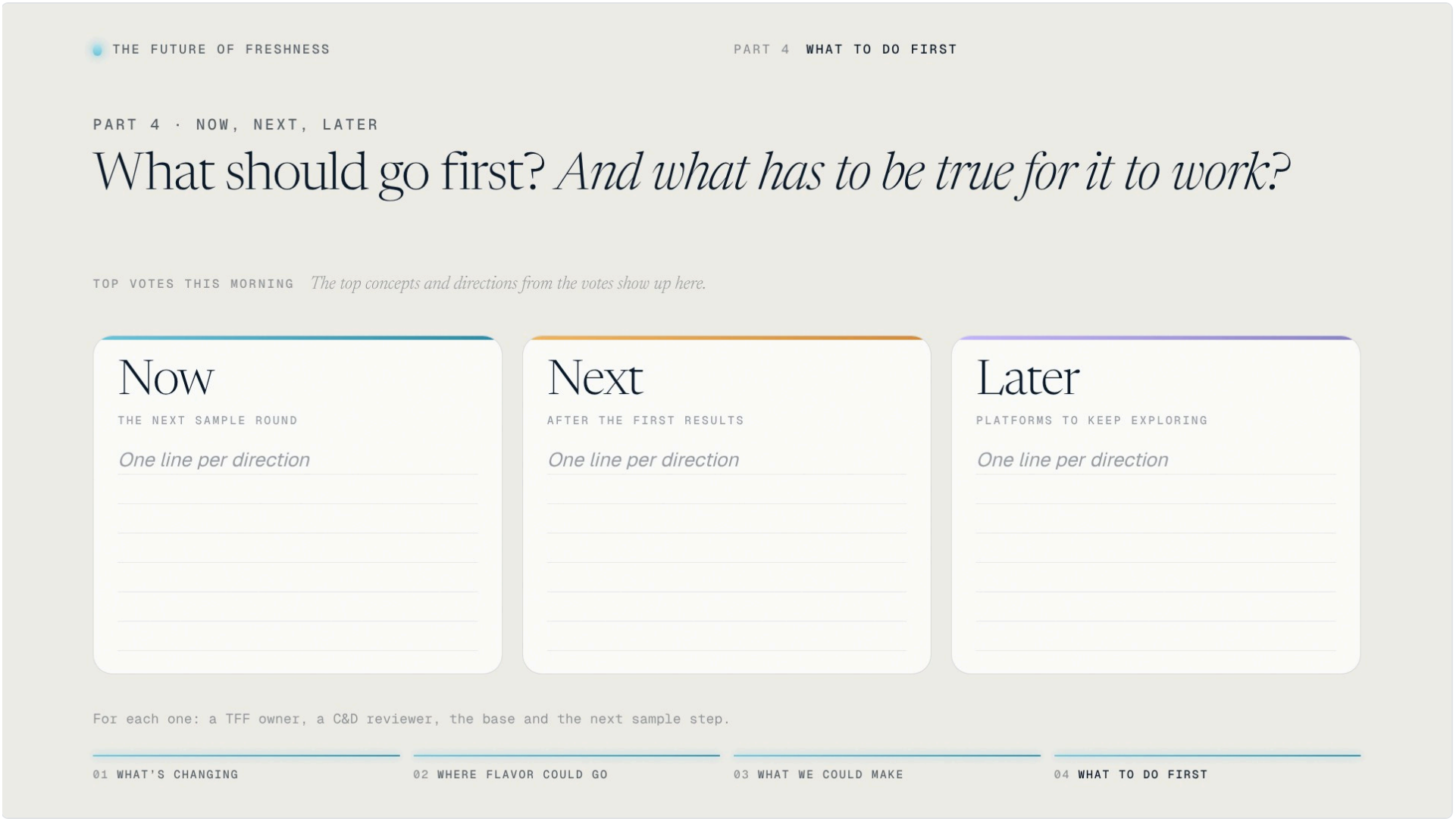
- Three dots each, on the concepts or samples they would develop. Stacking is fine.
- Build 1 shows the top three.



- Read Ross's words on screen, then talk it through:
- Where TheraBreath shows up in a day now, and where the concepts could fit.
- Now, Next and Later: the next sample round, after the first results, and ideas to keep exploring.
- Every direction leaves with a TFF owner, a C&D reviewer, a base and a next step.



- Moments of the day across, the consumers from the pre-brief down.
- Build 1: where we think TheraBreath is today (morning and night at the sink, and the dry mouth lozenge). Ask them to correct us.
- Build 2: their pre-brief answers. Build 3: everything still open.
- Click a cell to mark where a concept fits.



- Now, Next or Later for each concept and direction. One line each.
- For each one: a TFF owner, a C&D reviewer, the base, and the next sample step.
- What would you need to see in the next round of samples?



- Everything we decided this morning: the trends, the directions, the concepts and the plan.
- Read the plan back with the owners.
- Next build: the cover. We will send the write-up within 8 business days.



- The three next steps. The dates still need confirming before November 9.
- Then thank everyone.



- 11:48. Lights down, sound up. THE FLAVOR RACE runs 2:26.
- Don’t talk over it. When it ends, send everyone to lunch.



- 12:00. Lunch, hosted by Church & Dwight.